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Sept 2026

Reimagining the City...

Legend

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Luxury and Homes
Mr. Vikas Oberoi



DEVELOPERS DIARY
Mr. Jay Kotak

COVER STORY
MHADA: The Housing Mission

exclusive Interview
Sanjeev Jaiswal,IAS


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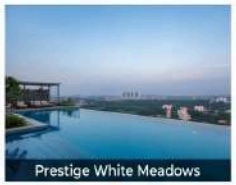
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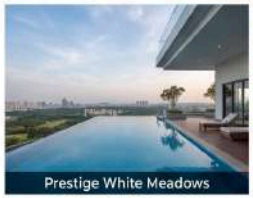
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CONTENT

10
MHADA's Bigger Picture
IAS SANJEEV JAISWAL



16
WHERE FIRE MEETS FABRIC
Gautam Singhania



THE DESIGN OF INHERITANCE
SARAH SHAM
22



Face of Courage
Vishwas Nagre Patil
26



DRIVING RELEVANCE AT SCALE
-GAYATRI V.YADAV
31



34
From Harvard to Home: MP Shrikant Shinde's Inspiring US Trip for Inclusive Growth



39
VIKAS OBEROI WHERE LUXURY MEETS LEGACY



44
THE FUTURE OF BANKING IS DIGITAL
-JAY KOTAK



49
SAREE,BOOTS & POINT TO PROVE
-KANGANA RANAUT



52
A COURT OF HIS OWN
-VIJAY SULE



55
THE ECOFEMINIST REWRITING
-SHREYA GHODAWAT



60
THE REWRITE
-TANMAY BHAT



64
THE ARCHITECT OF INSTITUTION
-VIRAANSH BHANUSHALI



68
ONE DROP AT A TIME
-CREP DOG CREW



THE LONG CONVERSATION
-RAJ SHAMANI
72



76
THE MALKIN
-PARUL GULATI



80
EKUAL BY
-KSHIRAJA SURENDRANATH

EKUAL

84
THE SECOND FOUNDER
-SHASHVAT GOENKA



88
PLAY STAY REPEAT
-COURT SIDE



92
THE NOOK
-HOME BUT BETTER



96
When Monsoon Meets Izakaya
-GIGI



EDITORIAL

What happens when the people rebuilding Mumbai's housing, banking, and skyline are all moving at once and in the same direction.



Legend is, in its second edition, still a young magazine. But the stories we are pursuing are not young. They are decades in the making. We are simply arriving at the moment when they are ready to be told.

There is a particular quality to the present moment in Mumbai that resists easy description. It is not optimism, exactly optimism implies uncertainty about the outcome. What one encounters instead is a kind of coordinated motion: institutions and individuals acting in parallel, each within their own mandate, yet producing something that feels, from the outside, like deliberate choreography.

The cover story of this edition sits at the heart of that motion. Shri Sanjeev Jaiswal, IAS, Vice President and CEO of MHADA, is not a man who talks about transformation in the abstract. He produces it in measurable units homes constructed, buildings redeveloped, grievances resolved within a hundred days. The scale of his current mandate, eight lakh homes across the Mumbai Metropolitan Region by 2030, is the kind of number that sounds like a press release until you visit the clusters he is redesigning. Then it becomes architectural reality.

What connects the stories in this edition is not sector or scale. It is a shared orientation toward the future: a refusal to be governed by what the past assumed was impossible. Whether the subject is affordable housing, digital banking, luxury real estate, or a padel court in Worli, the underlying question is the same what does this city deserve, and who is building it.

Legend is, in its second edition, still a young magazine. But the stories we are pursuing are not young. They are decades in the making. We are simply arriving at the moment when they are ready to be told.

India's most consequential stories are rarely the loudest ones. They compound quietly, in offices without press releases and decisions without fanfare. Our job is to find them before history does. We are still learning how to do that well. But we are learning fast.

"The city does not pause to explain itself. Nor should the journalism that covers it."

— Editor's Note, July 2026

म्हाडा
MHADA

From Housing Agency to Urban Transformer



30+
Years of Service

8 Lakh +
Homes Target in MMR

38,000 +
Jai Jeevan Mission Projects Revived

13,000 +
Cessed Buildings Earmkred For Redevelopment

Where Dreams Find Shelter

Building dignity, one home at a time.

MHADA has long stood as one of Maharashtra's most important institutions in the housing sector, and under the leadership of Sanjeev Jaiswal, it has continued to strengthen its role as a bridge between aspiration and access. At a time when urban housing in Mumbai and across the state has become increasingly difficult for the common citizen to afford, MHADA remains one of the most trusted names associated with hope, fairness, and opportunity. Its mission is simple yet powerful: to make homes accessible to people across income groups, especially those who might otherwise be left behind by the fast-moving real estate market. In that sense, MHADA is not just a housing authority it is a public institution that represents security, dignity, and the dream of homeownership for thousands of families. Sanjeev Jaiswal's leadership has brought a sharper, more modern focus to this mission. Known for his administrative clarity and development-oriented approach, he has helped position MHADA as a more efficient, transparent, and citizen-centric body. His work reflects a broader understanding of housing as more than just construction; it is about urban planning, social equity, and long-term vision. By emphasizing timely execution, process efficiency, and policy-driven action, Jaiswal has MHADA's image

As an institution that is responsive to the needs of today's Maharashtra. In a sector often slowed by complexity, his approach has been marked by discipline and purpose.What makes MHADA especially significant is its ability to serve as a real answer to one of the biggest challenges facing Indian cities affordable housing. For middle-class families, first-time homebuyers, and those seeking stability in a competitive urban landscape, MHADA continues to represent a credible path to ownership. Its importance lies not only in the number of homes it helps create, but in the confidence it gives people that home ownership is still possible. Under Sanjeev Jaiswal's stewardship, this mission has gained renewed energy, with a stronger emphasis on delivery, reform, and public value. That combination of vision and execution is what keeps MHADA relevant in today's housing conversation. At the heart of MHADA's story is the idea that housing is not a privilege for a few, but a foundation for many. Sanjeev Jaiswal's leadership reinforces this belief by keeping the institution aligned with those needs of the public it serves. Whether plannin, planning, redevelopment, or policy implementMHADA.





THE HOUSING PROMISE

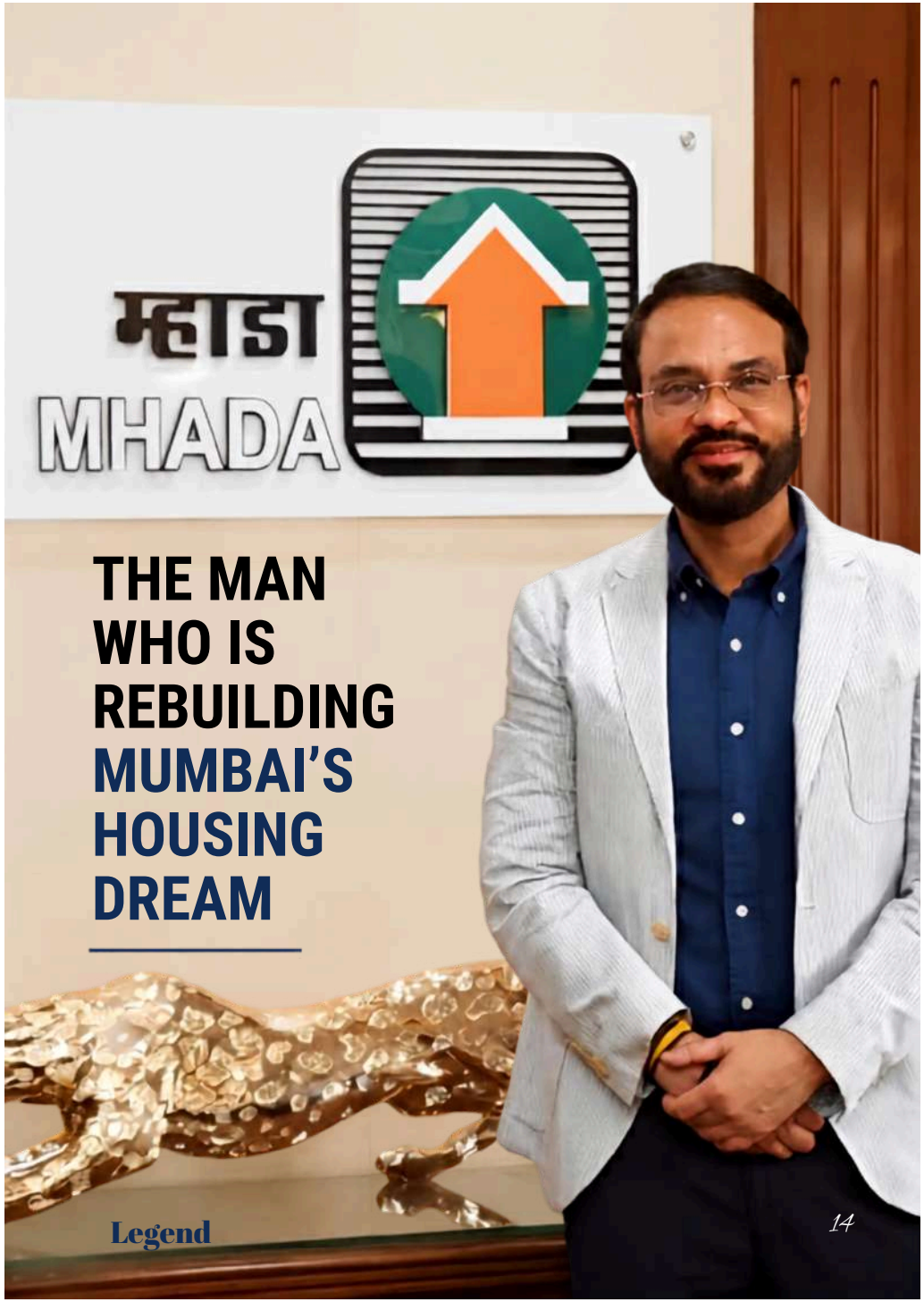
In the labyrinthine world of Indian public administration, where ambition frequently outpaces action and policy seldom finds its way to the street, Sri Sanjeev Jaiswal, IAS, stands as a rare and reassuring exception. A 1996-batch IAS officer with nearly three decades of distinguished service to the people of Maharashtra, he has consistently demonstrated that governance, when anchored in purpose and executed with precision, can change lives not in theory, but in the lived reality of millions. Today, as Vice President and Chief Executive Officer of the Maharashtra Housing and Area Development Authority (MHADA), Sri Jaiswal helms one of the most consequential civic mandates in the county: providing safe, dignified, and affordable housing to the citizens of Maharashtra's vast and ever-expanding urban landscape.

It is a mandate he does not merely administer he leads it with the conviction of someone who understands, deeply and personally, that a home is not simply a structure. It is stability. It is aspiration. It is the foundation on which every other possibility in a person's life is built. Before arriving at MHADA, Sri Jaiswal's career was already a masterclass in institutional leadership across Maharashtra's most demanding public roles. As District Collector in multiple districts, he developed an early and abiding fluency with ground realities the kind that is not taught in textbooks but earned through fieldwork, difficult decisions, and consistent accountability.



It is at MHADA, however, that the full sweep of Shri Jaiswal's vision has found its most defining expression. Under his stewardship, the organisation has undergone a transformation as significant as the buildings it seeks to redevelop. MHADA today is not merely a housing authority it is an institution reimagined; more transparent, more responsive; and more ambitious than at any point in its history. The numbers speak eloquently. Through the MMR Growth Hub Project, MHADA has committed to constructing eight lakh homes across the Mumbai Metropolitan Region by 2030 including 45,000 homes planned across seven key layouts in Mumbai alone. This is not an image that is yet to come on the past; it is an opportunity that was created on the past; it is a generational shift in scale, intent, and execution.

By transforming dense, deteriorated urban pockets Kamathipura, Worli, Goregaon, and others into modern, liveable communities with adequate open space, sanitation, and infrastructure, MHADA under his leadership is not just replacing old buildings. It is re-imagine what urban neighbourhoods in Mumbai can and should look like. Equally transformative has been Shri Jaiswal's 100-Day Action Plan a focused, time-bound governance intervention that cut through years of institutional inertia to deliver long-overdue relief to residents of ceased buildings and transit camps. For thousands of Mumbaikars who had waited for years sometimes decades to receive homes they had been promised, the 100-Day Action Plan was not a bureaucratic exercise. It was a turning point.



THE MAN WHO IS REBUILDING MUMBAI'S HOUSING DREAM

Beyond Bricks: The Governance Philosophy

DUTY, COURAGE, AND LEGACY

What distinguishes Shri Sanjeev Jaiswal from administrators of comparable seniority is not merely his track record impressive as it is but the philosophy that animates his work. He has articulated, with consistency and sincerity, three organising principles for governance: transparency, citizen participation, and sustainability. Under his watch, MHADA's processes have become more open and accessible. Lotteries are conducted digitally. Grievances are addressed through structured Janata Darbars. Citizens are no longer merely subjects of policy they are participants in it.

He has spoken often of the importance of building systems that outlast individual tenures institutions that citizens can trust long after any single officer has moved on. This orientation toward legacy rather than momentary achievement is rare in any profession. In public administration, it is exceptional. As Mumbai continues its relentless growth absorbing, year by year, new populations, new aspirations, and new pressures the work of authorities like MHADA becomes ever more critical. In that context, the leadership of Shri Sanjeev Jaiswal, IAS, represents something that the city's residents have every reason to value: an administrator who builds not just for the present, but for posterity. Not just homes, but hope. It is at MHADA, however, that the full sweep of Shri Jaiswal's vision has found its most defining expression. Under his stewardship, the organisation has undergone a transformation as significant as the buildings it seeks to redevelop. MHADA today is not merely a housing authority it is an institution reimagined: more transparent, more responsive, and more ambitious than at any point in its history. The numbers speak eloquently. Through the MMR Growth Hub Project, MHADA has committed to constructing eight lakh homes across the Mumbai Metropolitan Region by 2030 including 45,000 homes planned across seven key layouts in Mumbai alone. his is not an incremental improvement on the past; it is a generational shift in scale, intent, and execution. At the heart of this programme is Shri Jaiswal's signature approach: cluster redevelopment. By transforming dense, deteriorated urban pockets Kamathipura, Worli, Goregaon, and others into modern, liveable communities with adequate open space, sanitation, and infrastructure, MHADA under his leadership is not just replacing old buildings. It is re-imagining what urban neighbourhoods in Mumbai can and should look like. Equally transformative has been Shri Jaiswal's 100-Day Action Plan a focused, time-bound governance intervention that cut through years of institutional inertia to deliver long-overdue relief to residents of cessed buildings and transit camps. For thousands of Mumbaikars who had waited for years sometimes decades to receive homes they had been promised, the 100-Day Action Plan was not a bureaucratic exercise. It was a turning point. Flats were allotted. Grievances were resolved. Families moved in.

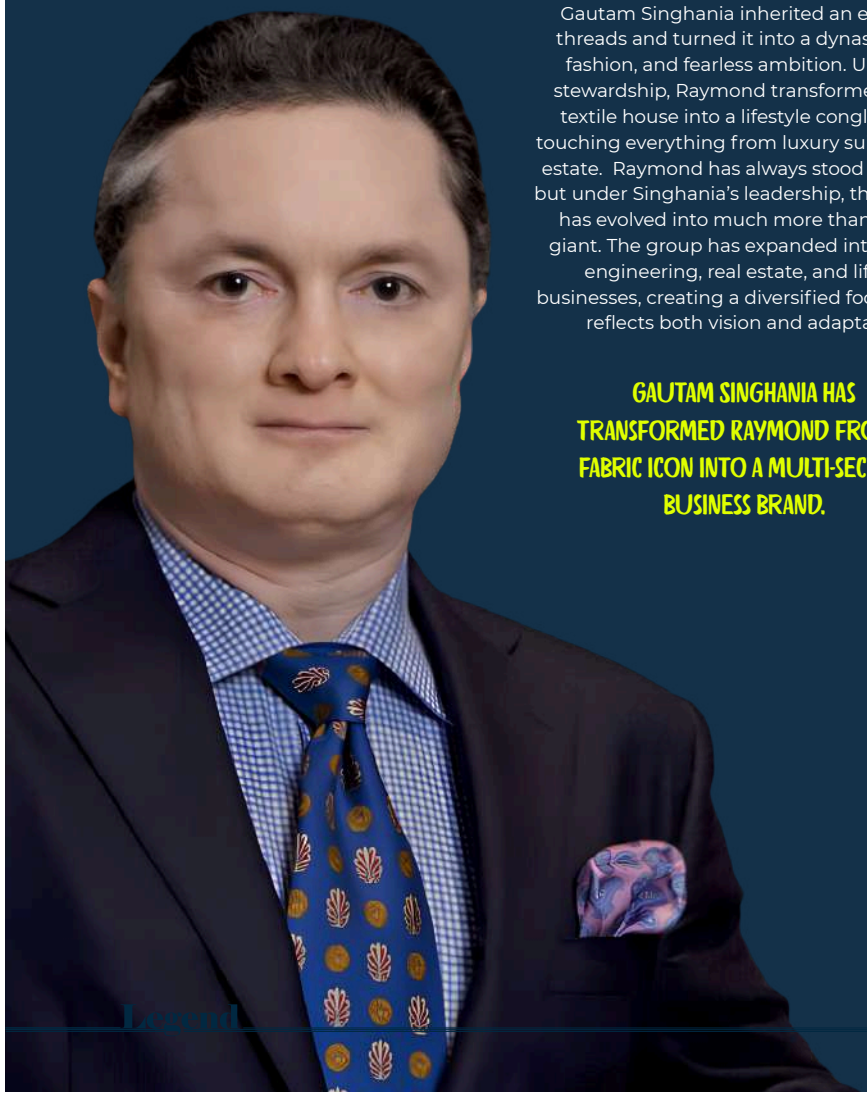
Building Tomorrow: The Legacy Left Behind

"To make quality, affordable, and dignified housing accessible to every deserving family, while building a more transparent, efficient, and people-centric MHADA that strengthens Maharashtra's urban future."

— *Shri Sanjeev Jaiswal, Vice President & CEO MHADA*

THE KING WHO NEVER BRAKED

FIRE MEETS FABRIC



Gautam Singhania inherited an empire of threads and turned it into a dynasty of fire, fashion, and fearless ambition. Under his stewardship, Raymond transformed from a textile house into a lifestyle conglomerate touching everything from luxury suiting to real estate. Raymond has always stood for quality, but under Singhania's leadership, the company has evolved into much more than a textile giant. The group has expanded into apparel, engineering, real estate, and lifestyle businesses, creating a diversified footprint that reflects both vision and adaptability.

GAUTAM SINGHANIA HAS TRANSFORMED RAYMOND FROM A FABRIC ICON INTO A MULTI-SECTOR BUSINESS BRAND.

The Man Steering Raymond Into a New Era

Gautam Singhania has taken Raymond beyond its classic identity as India's most trusted suiting brand and shaped it into a modern business powerhouse. As Chairman and Managing Director, he has led a bold transformation that blends tradition with ambition, keeping the brand vibrant in a fast-changing market. Raymond has always stood for quality, but under Singhania's leadership, the company has evolved into much more than a textile giant.

The group has expanded into apparel, engineering, real estate, and lifestyle businesses, creating a diversified footprint that reflects both vision and adaptability. One of Singhania's defining strengths is his ability to restructure for long-term value. He pushed Raymond to shed non-core businesses and sharpen its focus on high-quality materials, allowing the company to become cleaner, stronger, and more versatile. This approach has helped Raymond build momentum in premium lifestyle categories while strengthening shareholder value.

Building Beyond Textiles

Raymond's evolution under Singhania reflects a clear move from textiles to a broader lifestyle and business ecosystem.

Leadership With a Distinct Style

Singhania's leadership style is often described as bold, derisive, and brand-conscious. He has kept Raymond's identity premium while ensuring that the company adapts to new consumer preferences and business realities. That balance between legacy and innovation is what makes his journey particularly notable. In the Indian industry, Raymond stands as the premier in transition, but also in expansion. Its transformation into focused verticals signals a new chapter, one built on sharper execution and cleaner market positioning. Gautam Singhania's role in this journey makes him one of the key figures driving the reinvention of an iconic Indian enterprise, from rising to strategy. Gautam Singhania continues to shape Raymond's next chapter.

Gautam Singhania's story is not just about managing a family business; it is about renewing a legacy for the modern age. By combining brand strength with strategic reinvention, he has helped Raymond stay powerful, relevant, and aspirational. In a business world that rewards change, Singhania has ensured that Raymond keeps moving forward without losing its soul. For decades, Raymond has been one of India's most recognized and respected business names, closely associated with fine fabrics, tailored elegance, and timeless quality. At the center of this legacy stands Gautam Singhania, the chairman who has played a defining role in reshaping the company for a changing India.





Singhania represents a rare kind of industrial leadership one that respects heritage while refusing to remain bound by it. Under his stewardship, Raymond has moved from being seen primarily as a fabric company to becoming a broader lifestyle and business group with interests across apparel, real estate, and engineering. This evolution has made the company more dynamic, more diversified, and better prepared for the future.

Raymond's journey has always been about quality, but Gautam Singhania has given that legacy a modern direction. In a business environment where consumer expectations change rapidly, he has focused on keeping the brand relevant without diluting its identity. That is not an easy balance to achieve. Many companies struggle when they try to modernize an old brand, but Raymond has managed to maintain its premium appeal while opening new growth avenues.

From Heritage to High Growth

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Rather than trying to do everything at once, the company has leaned into focused growth, sharper execution, and a clearer identity. This approach has helped Raymond become more agile in a competitive market. The strength of this strategy lies in its simplicity. Raymond did not abandon its core strengths; it built outward from them. That is why the brand still commands trust in fabrics and menswear, even as it grows in newer segments. It is a reminder that reinvention works best when it is rooted in authenticity. What makes Gautam Singhania's leadership especially interesting is that he has not limited Raymond to its traditional image. The company has steadily expanded into areas that reflect the way India is changing. Its presence in real estate, for instance, shows a deeper understanding of modern urban growth and the demand for premium development. Engineering remains another important pillar, adding industrial strength to the group's overall structure. This diversification is not just about entering new sectors. It is about building a business ecosystem that can create value across different markets.





The Raymond Vision

Leadership in a Changing Market

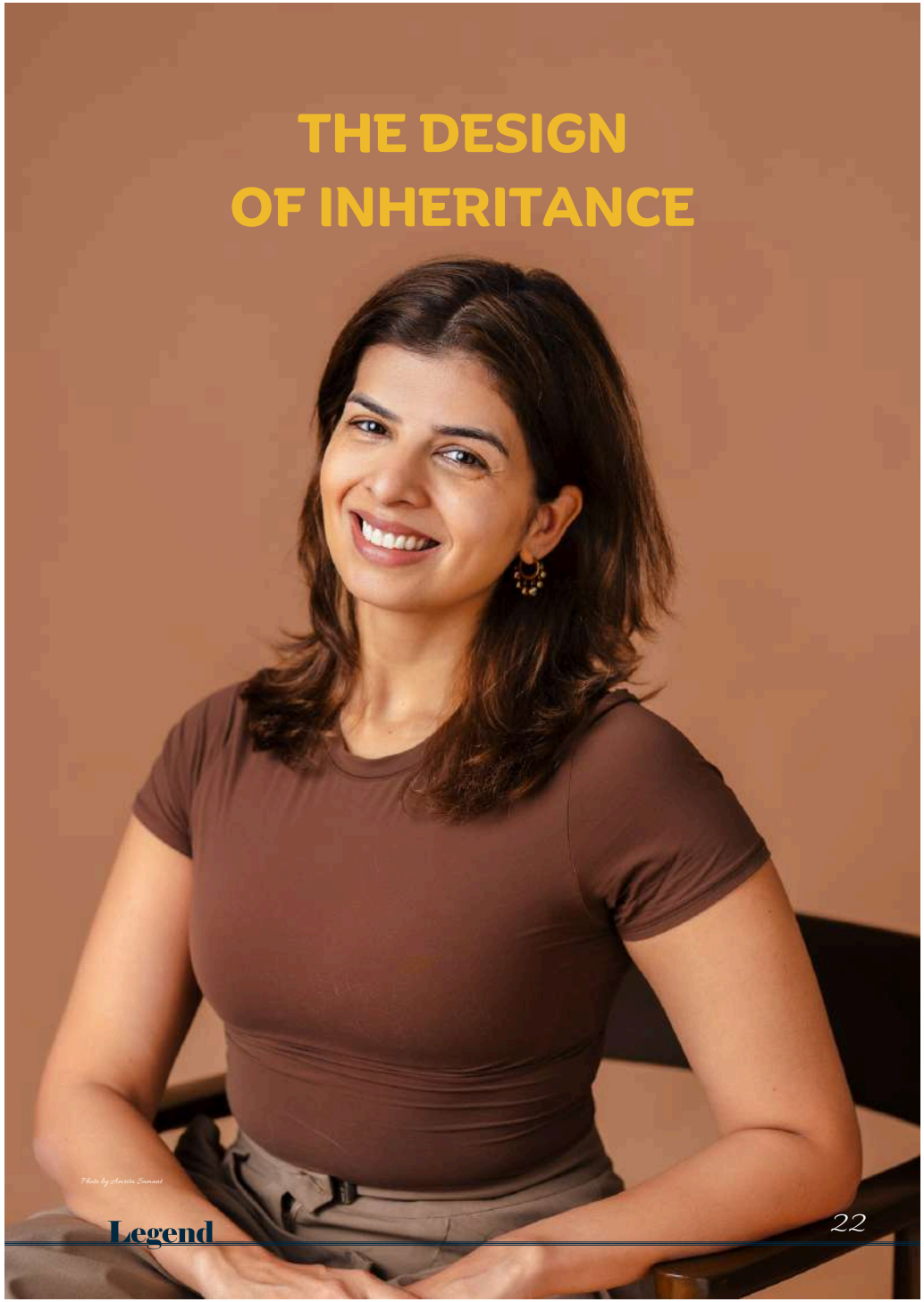
Gautam Singhania's legacy is still unfolding, but its direction is already clear. He has helped Raymond move from being known mainly for textiles to being recognized as a broader, more ambitious corporate group. That transformation reflects vision, decisiveness, and a strong understanding of what brand leadership means in the modern age. His story is not simply about inheriting a business empire. It is about actively shaping it, refreshing it, and preparing it for the next generation. In that sense, Singhania's role at Raymond goes beyond management.

He has become a symbol of how Indian legacy businesses can evolve while still honoring their roots. Raymond today stands at the intersection of heritage and reinvention, and Gautam Singhania is the architect of that balance. His leadership has ensured that the brand remains iconic, but not outdated; familiar, but not static; respected, but still ambitious. That is what makes his journey compelling and why Raymond continues to matter in India's business landscape. That gives the group flexibility and resilience, both of which matter greatly in uncertain times.

ABOUT GAUTAM SINGHANIA

Gautam Singhania stands out as a leader who has carried Raymond's legacy into a modern era with clarity and ambition. By combining tradition with bold strategic thinking, he has helped transform the company from a classic textile brand into a diversified business with a stronger future.

THE DESIGN OF INHERITANCE



DESIGN FOUND HER

Half Creativity, Half Commerce

How Sarah Sham Turned a 110-Year Legacy Into Contemporary Design's Most Honest Voice. There is a particular kind of weight that comes with a legendary surname in India's design world. Essajees 110 years of craftsmanship, antiques, and aesthetic refinement does not whisper. It announces. Three generations of building something that matters, woven so completely into the fabric of Indian interiors that the family name has become almost synonymous with excellence itself. Sarah Sham could have worn that legacy comfortably. She could have inherited a studio, a reputation, a ready-made clientele. Instead, she chose to do something far more interesting: she questioned it. Design found Sarah Sham almost by accident or perhaps design was simply patient. Her academic journey centered on art history and business, disciplines that seemed to point toward curatorial work or commerce. But somewhere in the intersection of those two worlds, something else emerged. She realized that design brought together everything she loved: history, aesthetics, problem-solving, and fundamentally,
"I never grew up believing I would become an interior designer," she reflects.

Not having a predetermined path, she suggests, made her more curious. More open. Even now, after 130 projects across 11 cities, she approaches each commission with what she calls "the mindset of a student rather than someone who already has all the answers." That curiosity has shaped not just her philosophy, but the entire practice. Essajees Atelier, the studio she leads, has become known for something almost radical in a field prone to signatures and styles: a deliberate refusal to have one.

In most design studios, consistency is doctrine. A recognizable aesthetic becomes a brand. Clients hire you because they know exactly what they'll get. Sarah's approach inverts this entirely.

"For us, the client should always be the signature, not the designer," she says. "Every family lives differently, every business has a different story, and every site presents its own opportunities."

This isn't modesty. It's clarity. She understands something that many designers take years—if they ever—to learn: that spaces are not canvases for the designer's vision. They are homes and workplaces for the people who will inhabit them.





"Beautiful interiors are often the outcome of asking better questions."

- Sarah Sham
Co-Founder of Essajees Atelier

Interior design is one of the most intimate professional relationships a person can have. You work with clients for over a year. You make countless decisions together. You become part of some of their most personal moments raising children in a home, building a business in an office, grieving in a space they've made sacred."I never grew up believing I would become an interior designer," she reflects.

Sarah has learned to choose her clients not by budget or project scale, but by what she calls "energy and synergy."
"If there is mutual trust, respect and good energy, the entire journey becomes collaborative rather than transactional," she explains. "I've found that this chemistry almost always leads to stronger design outcomes because everyone feels comfortable exploring ideas honestly."





She has immense respect for what previous generations built at Essajees. But she also knew she had to create something that reflected her own values and vision. My advice would be to embrace the foundation you've inherited while giving yourself permission to evolve it. Your identity is built not by rejecting the past, but by adding your own chapter to it.
This is not about revolution. It's about evolution. Taking what your predecessors built—the credibility, the relationships, the understanding of craft—and using it as a foundation to ask different questions and pursue different possibilities.

VISHWAS NAGRE PATIL
FACE OF COURAGE



The Man Who Stood Firm

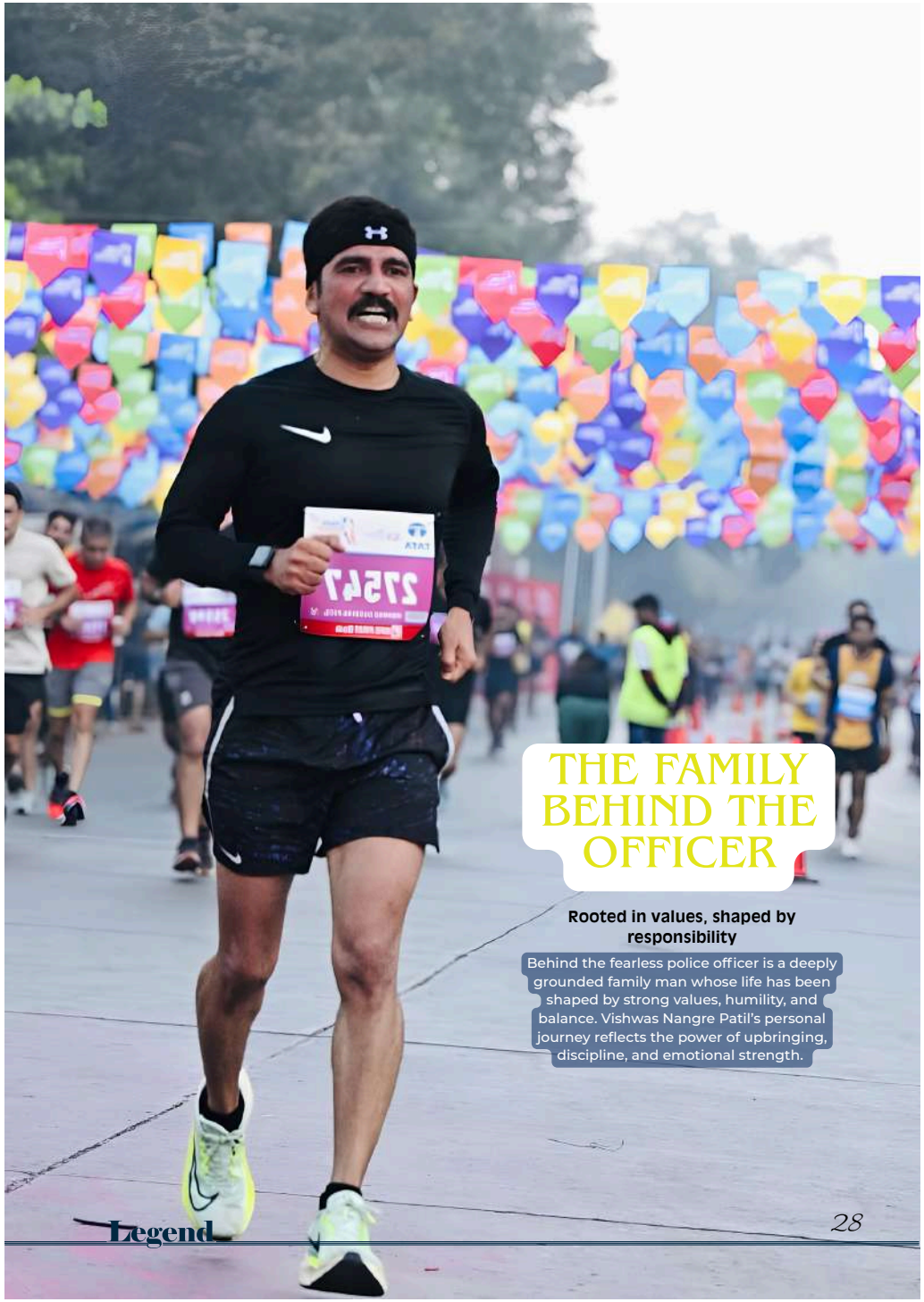
One of those rare officers whose name has become synonymous with courage and commitment. A senior IPS officer of Maharashtra, he is remembered across the country for his fearless role during the 26/11 Mumbai terror attacks, when the city was under one of the darkest and most brutal assaults in its history. While many were trying to understand the scale of the tragedy, Vishwas Nangre Patil was already on the ground, responding with urgency, calm, and a deep sense of duty. His actions during the Taj Hotel operation became a powerful example of what police service can mean in its purest form immediate, selfless, and unshaken in the face of danger. What makes his story extraordinary is not only the courage he showed that night, but the years of service that shaped him before and after it. He has served in multiple key roles across Maharashtra, including in Mumbai, Thane, Pune Rural, Latur, and Nashik, earning a reputation for being sharp, humane, and deeply committed to public service.



Duty, Courage, and a Legacy of Service

His career has included work in law and order, anti-corruption, and district policing, and he has consistently been known as an officer who takes responsibility seriously and acts with purpose. His gallantry was officially recognized when he received the President's Police Medal for Gallantry in 2015 for his role in the 26/11 counterterror operations. Vishwas Nangre Patil's significance goes beyond one heroic night. He represents the ideal image of a public servant someone who combines operational strength with human sensitivity. In interviews and public appearances, he has often spoken about the emotional weight of policing, the memories of 26/11 that continue to stay with him, and the importance of team work.

For many young Indians, especially those aspiring to join the civil services, he stands as a living example of how discipline and integrity can shape a meaningful career. His journey reminds us that heroes are not only made in moments of crisis, but through years of steady, unseen dedication. His journey is inspiring because it reflects more than just one moment of bravery it reflects a lifetime of discipline, service, and quiet strength. From managing law and order to standing at the frontlines during critical moments, he has shown what true leadership looks like in public service. What makes him stand out is the balance he brings between authority and humanity, proving that a good officer is not only strict in duty but also deeply committed to protecting people.



THE FAMILY BEHIND THE OFFICER

Rooted in values, shaped by responsibility

Behind the fearless police officer is a deeply grounded family man whose life has been shaped by strong values, humility, and balance. Vishwas Nangre Patil's personal journey reflects the power of upbringing, discipline, and emotional strength.



A Hero at Home Too

His family life offers a softer, more personal side to the man often seen in the public eye as a tough and fearless officer.His family story is also a reminder that extraordinary careers are sustained by ordinary acts of support at home. The demands of policing, especially at senior levels, are intense and often unpredictable. In such a life, family becomes the anchor a source of calm, strength, and perspective. Vishwas Nangre Patil's journey shows that behind every public role is a private world that matters just as deeply.

His ability to balance service with family speaks to the discipline not just of a police officer, but of a person who understands responsibility in its fullest sense. What makes his family story especially compelling is the contrast it creates with the high-pressure world he inhabits. While he has faced terrorism, crime, and administrative pressure in his professional life, his personal world reflects warmth, continuity, and values. He is often seen as a role model not only for officers and aspirants, but also for families who value integrity, commitment, and strong moral grounding. The story of Vishwas Nangre Patil is therefore not only about a celebrated officer — it is also about the family that stands behind him and the values that continue to guide him



"Courage is not the absence of fear, but the discipline to stand firm, act fast, and protect others when it matters most."
- **Vishwas Nagre Patil, IPS**

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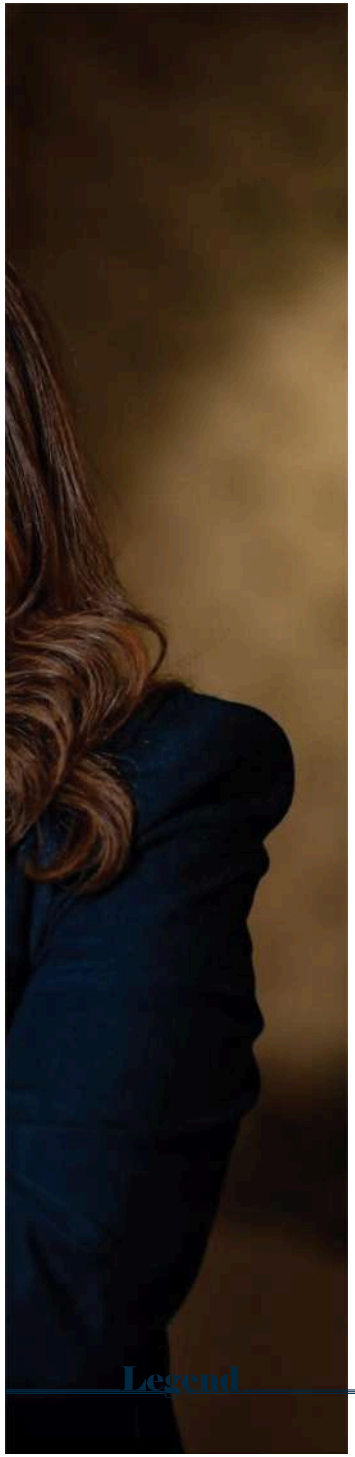
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BUILDING A LEGACY OF EXCELLENCE. HIRANANDANI COMMUNITY.

Driving Relevance at Scale!

Across consumer brands, entertainment, digital platforms and venture capital, Gayatri V. Yadav has built a career around understanding how brands stay meaningful as consumers and the world around them change.

-Group CMO and EVP Strategic Initiatives, Chairmans Office
Reliance Industries Limited



There are few careers in marketing that have moved across as many different expressions of the consumer as Gayatri V. Yadav's. From packaged foods to entertainment, from building brands to working with entrepreneurs, each chapter has offered a different view of what makes a brand matter.

Today, as Group Chief Marketing Officer and Executive Vice President, Strategic Initiatives at Reliance Industries, those experiences come together across an organisation with businesses spanning energy, retail, digital services, media and new commerce. Her career began at Procter & Gamble, where she developed a grounding in the fundamentals of brand management and consumer understanding. At General Mills India, that foundation was put to work in launching and scaling Pillsbury, building a brand at a time when the packaged foods category was still evolving in India.

That experience was followed by a move into entertainment, where the relationship between consumer, culture and brand became even more pronounced. At Star India, Yadav worked across marketing, consumer strategy and innovation, with the launch of Star Sports and Hotstar among the defining projects of the period. Campaigns such as Nayi Soch and Mauka Mauka showed how brands can become part of a much larger cultural conversation. Each move brought a different lesson. Consumer goods offered the discipline of building a habit and a category. Media brought the power of stories, entertainment and shared experiences. Her years at Peak XV (formerly Sequoia India & SEA) added another lens: working with founders and businesses that were using technology and innovation to create new categories and new ways of connecting with consumers. Her own description of these experiences is revealing - different chapters, but each contributing to a broader understanding of how consumer, brand and technology can come together.



Since joining Reliance in 2025, Yadav has brought these perspectives to an unusually broad portfolio. Working with the Group's leadership on brand and strategic priorities, her role spans businesses with very different consumers, categories and contexts. The challenge is not simply to market each business, but to understand what makes each relevant while staying connected to the larger opportunity.

That question is becoming increasingly important as marketing itself evolves. Consumers today move effortlessly between physical and digital worlds, discovering, considering and buying across stores, screens, apps and platforms. Technology is opening up new possibilities too. Artificial intelligence is making it possible to understand consumers with greater precision and create more relevant experiences at scale.

For Yadav, this represents an exciting new phase for the profession rather than a departure from its fundamentals. As she has said in recent conversations, marketing is moving from an era of reach to one of relevance - using technology and intelligence to make brands more meaningful to individual consumers.



From Harvard to Home: MP Shrikant Shinde's Inspiring US Trip for Inclusive Growth



Shiv Sena MP and Kalyan Lok Sabha representative Dr. Shrikant Eknath Shinde recently completed a prestigious executive program at the Harvard Kennedy School in Massachusetts, USA marking a significant milestone in his 12-year parliamentary career. The three-time Member of Parliament successfully finished the week-long intensive course on "Strategies for Inclusive Growth," which focused on development strategies and inclusive growth for policymakers. Shinde completed this certificate program on coinciding with Maharashtra Day, adding symbolic significance to this achievement and making it an even more special and proud moment for him and the entire state of Maharasht. The program brought together distinguished faculty members including Professor Ricardo Hausmann and Professor Matt Andrews, along with participants from across the globe who are policymakers and leaders committed to addressing economic inequality and development challenges

Shinde's main objective for attending this program was to broaden his perspective through interactions with these distinguished faculty members and fellow participants, enabling him to adopt a more comprehensive, inclusive, and impact-driven approach to governance and constituency development. He emphasized that the interactions he had during this week-long program instilled renewed energy and motivation to continue working towards the development goals he has been pursuing for over a decade as an MP. Over the past 12 years, Shrikant Shinde has consistently worked towards holistic development, economic growth, and social welfare in his Kalyan-Dombivli constituency, and this Harvard program has equipped him with renewed tools and perspectives to accelerate these efforts. The course focused specifically on strategies for addressing economic inequality and creating inclusive growth models that can be adapted to grassroots realities in Maharashtra and India.

A Proud Maharashtra Moment at Harvard Kennedy School

From Harvard Kennedy School to the streets of Kalyan-Dombivli, MP Dr. Shrikant Shinde proves that global excellence and local roots can coexist beautifully. Completing Harvard's prestigious "Strategies for Inclusive Growth" program on Maharashtra Day itself, he brings world-class policy insights back home to transform his constituency. Even 10,000 miles away in Boston, a simple bite of Vada Pav reminded him and millions of Maharashtrians that no distance can sever the connection to one's roots. Over 12 years of parliamentary service, renewed energy from Harvard, and an unwavering commitment to inclusive development define his mission.



Sharp ideas, global perspectives, meaningful conversations building growth that includes everyone"

Dr. Shrikant Eknath Shinde has transformed his Kalyan Lok Sabha constituency into a model of urban development over his three terms as MP since 2014. His most significant achievement includes completing the fifth and sixth railway lines between Thane and Kalyan a project that had been stalled for over 25 years which increased nearly 50 local train services on the Kalyan-Kasara and Kalyan-Karjat routes, relieving daily commuters in one of India's most densely populated areas with over 35 lakh people. He got ₹1,000 crore sanctioned for the Kalyan-Airoli elevated road corridor, ₹110 crore for Dombivli MIDC road development, and ₹453 crore approved for the Kalyan-Thane-Mumbai Waterway Transport Project Phase I. The single-lane Kalyan-Shil road was widened into a six-lane road, nearly 70% of constituency roads are now concretized (targeting 100% pothole-free in two years), and the Kalyan Railway Yard Remodeling Project (₹800 crore) is underway to segregate outstation mail trains from suburban services. Additionally, the Thane-Bhiwandi-Kalyan Metro and Kalyan-Taloja Metro routes have been sanctioned with work already started.





Healthcare Revolution: From One Rupee Clinics to Multi-Specialty Hospitals

As a practicing orthopaedic surgeon turned politician, Shrikant Shinde has made healthcare his signature priority through his Shrikant Shinde Foundation. During the COVID-19 pandemic, he donated ambulances, organized free medical camps in Sindhudurg, and helped thousands through "One Rupee Clinics" that provided affordable healthcare to underserved communities. His constituency now boasts a nearly 200-bed multi-speciality hospital under Ulhasnagar Municipal Corporation (PPP model), a ₹102 crore, 100-bed ESIC Kamgar Hospital in Ulhasnagar (opening in 3-4 months), a cancer hospital in Dombivli (bhoomipujan completed), and dialysis centres with NICU and PICU units in Thakurli and Dombivli respectively. Most significantly, ₹403 crore has been sanctioned for a medical college in Ambernath, addressing the critical shortage of medical education infrastructure in the region. His health camps and mobile clinics have brought healthcare services closer to people in underserved areas, reflecting his commitment as a doctor-politician.

VIKAS OBEROI
WHERE LUXURY MEETS LEGACY





LUXURY meets its destination and price

Vikas Oberoi, MD and CEO of Oberoi Realty Limited, has transformed his father D.P. Oberoi's vision into India's most prestigious luxury real estate empire. Under his leadership, Oberoi Realty has developed over 44 million square feet of inventory across Mumbai's most coveted locations, with a market capitalization exceeding ₹10,000 crore. His journey from inheriting a family legacy to becoming India's most respected real estate leader spans over 25 years of unbroken excellence and consistent delivery. Vikas Oberoi's philosophy is simple yet powerful: quality over quantity. While competitors rushed to maximize density, he championed open spaces, world-class amenities, and sustainable architecture. His iconic projects Oberoi Gardens, The Oberoi Esplanade, Oberoi Aurum, and Oberoi Sky City have become benchmarks for luxury living in Mumbai.

He believes in building for generations, not just for transactions, and every Oberoi project carries a promise of excellence, sustainability, and timeless luxury that resonates with discerning buyers across the country. The numbers speak for themselves. In FY24, Oberoi Realty delivered revenue of ₹5,036 crore, up 22% year-over-year, with profit after tax reaching ₹1,047 crore, a 28% increase. Bookings crossed ₹6,500 crore, and the company maintained a perfect delivery record with 100% on-time completion and zero defaults across all projects. This financial excellence, combined with an 85%+ sell-through rate and over 60% customer retention, proves that Vikas Oberoi's customer-first approach has created not just buildings, but lasting trust. Sustainability is not a buzzword for Vikas Oberoi it is a core value. He committed Oberoi Realty to net-zero carbon operations and LEED-certified buildings well before sustainability became industry standard.

Best Luxury Real Estate Developer India Real Estate Awards 2025

His developments feature solar power, rainwater harvesting, green certifications, and energy-efficient infrastructure. He has often said that sustainability is not a trend but a responsibility to future generations, and this philosophy is embedded in every square foot of Oberoi's portfolio. His customer-centric approach has created a loyal following built on personalized consultation, transparent pricing with no hidden costs, post-sale service that extends decades after possession, and community-building through resident welfare programs. Vikas Oberoi treats customers not as buyers but as family, believing that Oberoi builds homes, not just transactions. This mindset has earned him recognition as Best Luxury Real Estate Developer at the India Real Estate Awards 2025, CEO of the Year at the Economic Times Property Awards 2024, and a spot among Forbes India's Top 10 Real Estate Titans in 2023.Looking ahead, Vikas Oberoi's vision extends beyond Mumbai. His roadmap includes expanding into Pune and NCR by 2027, building a 50+ million sq. ft. pipeline by 2028, integrating smart city IoT-enabled homes, and entering the affordable luxury segment without compromising quality. He is committed to India's infrastructure growth while maintaining Oberoi's luxury positioning, aligning with the government's Housing for All mission. In Vikas Oberoi's own words: "In real estate, you build projects. In life, you build relationships. At Oberoi, we do both." He isn't just shaping Mumbai's skyline he's shaping India's real estate future, proving that quality, sustainability, and customer trust remain the ultimate competitive advantages in any market.



From legacy to future, Vikas Oberoi continues to build tomorrow's landmarks today, one masterpiece at a time.

The Visionary Redefining India's Urban Landscape

Vikas Oberoi stands as one of India's most influential real estate leaders, steering Oberoi Realty Limited to extraordinary heights as MD and CEO. What began as a family vision from his father D.P. Oberoi has flourished under Vikas's leadership into a ₹10,000+ crore powerhouse that has developed over 44 million square feet across Mumbai's most sought-after locations. His 25-year journey represents more than business success it embodies a commitment to excellence, integrity, and building spaces where people truly want to live, work, and thrive. What truly sets Vikas Oberoi apart is his forward-thinking commitment to sustainability. Long before green building became industry terminology, he pledged Oberoi Realty to net-zero carbon operations and LEED certification across all developments.



Sustainability Leader Green Building Council India 2024

His projects integrate solar power systems, rainwater harvesting, energy-efficient infrastructure, and environmentally conscious design that reduces carbon footprints while enhancing living quality. He views sustainability not as a marketing strategy but as a moral obligation to future generations, ensuring that the landmarks he builds today remain vibrant and functional for decades to come. Vikas Oberoi's customer-first philosophy extends far beyond the sale transaction. Every buyer receives personalized consultation, transparent pricing without hidden costs, and post-sale service that continues decades after possession. The company actively builds communities through resident welfare programs, creating neighborhoods Where people form lasting connections rather than just sharing addresses. This approach has earned Oberoi Realty recognition as India's most trusted luxury real estate brand and Vikas personal accolades including Best Luxury Real Estate Developer at India Real Estate Awards 2025, CEO of the Year at Economic Times Property Awards 2024, and Sustainability Leader from the Green Building Council India 2024. Looking toward the future, Vikas Oberoi's vision extends well beyond Mumbai's borders. He is strategically expanding into Pune and the National Capital Region by 2027, building a pipeline of 50+ million square feet by 2028, and integrating smart city technologies with IoT-enabled homes that respond to residents' needs. He is also entering the affordable luxury segment, making Oberoi's quality accessible to a broader audience without compromising the brand's standards.



Where Family Values Build Family Homes

For Vikas Oberoi, real estate is never just about bricks and mortar it's about families, dreams, and legacies. Following in the footsteps of his father D.P. Oberoi, who founded Oberoi Realty with a simple yet powerful vision, Vikas has carried forward not just a business but a family promise to build homes where generations can thrive together. He often says that every family who buys an Oberoi home becomes part of the Oberoi family, and this belief is rooted in the values his father instilled in him: integrity, quality, and treating every customer like family. Vikas remembers visiting construction sites with his father as a young boy, watching him personally inspect every detail and speak with future homeowners about their dreams, teaching him that building a home is about building trust. Today, with over 60% of Oberoi customers returning for second or third purchases, many from the same family across generations, Vikas sees his father's legacy alive in every family that celebrates anniversaries, raises children, and creates memories within Oberoi walls. He believes that a house becomes a home not because of its size or luxury, but because of the love, laughter, and memories shared within it, and that is why he approaches every project with the mindset of building for his own family. For Vikas Oberoi, the greatest reward isn't awards or revenue it's hearing from a family that their child was born in their Oberoi home, or that grandparents, parents, and children now live together under one Oberoi roof, continuing the beautiful cycle of family, togetherness, and legacy that started with his father's vision and continues with every home he builds today.

THE FUTURE OF BANKING IS DIGITAL





Redefining digital banking for India

Jay Kotak is the driving force behind Kotak811, India's foremost digital banking business incubated within Kotak Mahindra Bank. His vision is clear: "Banks of the future must provide real-time customer service, personalized data-driven experiences, and seamless digital interactions." Under his leadership, Kotak811 has become India's most downloaded mobile banking app, serving 25+ million customers with AI-driven banking, instant account opening, and 24/7 digital support. Jay believes in combining Kotak Bank's conservative risk management with aggressive digital innovation, creating a powerful formula that serves India's tech-savvy generation.

Jay's personal values reflect the extraordinary family he comes from. His mother Pallavi Uday Kotak is an entrepreneur and professional mountaineer who trekked to Everest Base Camp in 2014, teaching him courage and perseverance. His brother Dhawal graduated from Columbia Business School, continuing the family's tradition of excellence. Jay married Aditi Arya (Miss India World 2015, Yale MBA) in November 2023, combining legacy with elegance as the couple represents India's new generation of business leaders. His personal motto"Feet on the ground, eyes to the sky" captures his approach to banking: respecting tradition while looking toward the future



The Father-Son Story Behind India's Banking Empire

Uday Kotak's story is one of India's greatest entrepreneurial journeys. Born in 1959 to a Gujarati cotton-trading family in Mumbai, he grew up in a massive joint family with 60 people living under one roof a unique environment he called "Capitalism at work and Socialism at home." At just 26 years old in 1985, Uday made a bold decision: he turned down a lucrative job offer from a multinational corporation and started his own financial services company with barely ₹30 lakh (less than $80,000) borrowed from family and friends. His father ran a traditional textile business, but Uday chose a different path, starting Kotak Capital Management Finance Ltd. in a tiny 300 sq ft office in Fort, Mumbai, focusing on bill discounting a niche financial service for small businesses that banks were ignoring.

The pivotal moment came in 1986 at Uday's wedding, where he met Anand Mahindra, the prominent industrialist who had just returned from Harvard. Impressed by Uday's clarity, vision, and ambition, Anand Mahindra invested ₹4 lakh of his personal funds to acquire a 5% stake in the company. This partnership led to the company being renamed Kotak Mahindra Finance Ltd, and with Mahindra's support, the firm expanded into car financing, investment banking, and eventually became India's third-largest private sector bank by market capitalization with over 1,752 branches and assets worth $68 billion (as of March 2022). The transformative moment came in 2003 when Kotak became the first Indian NBFC to receive a banking license, officially evolving into Kotak Mahindra Bank—a milestone that established Uday as Asia's richest banker with a net worth of $15.28 billion.

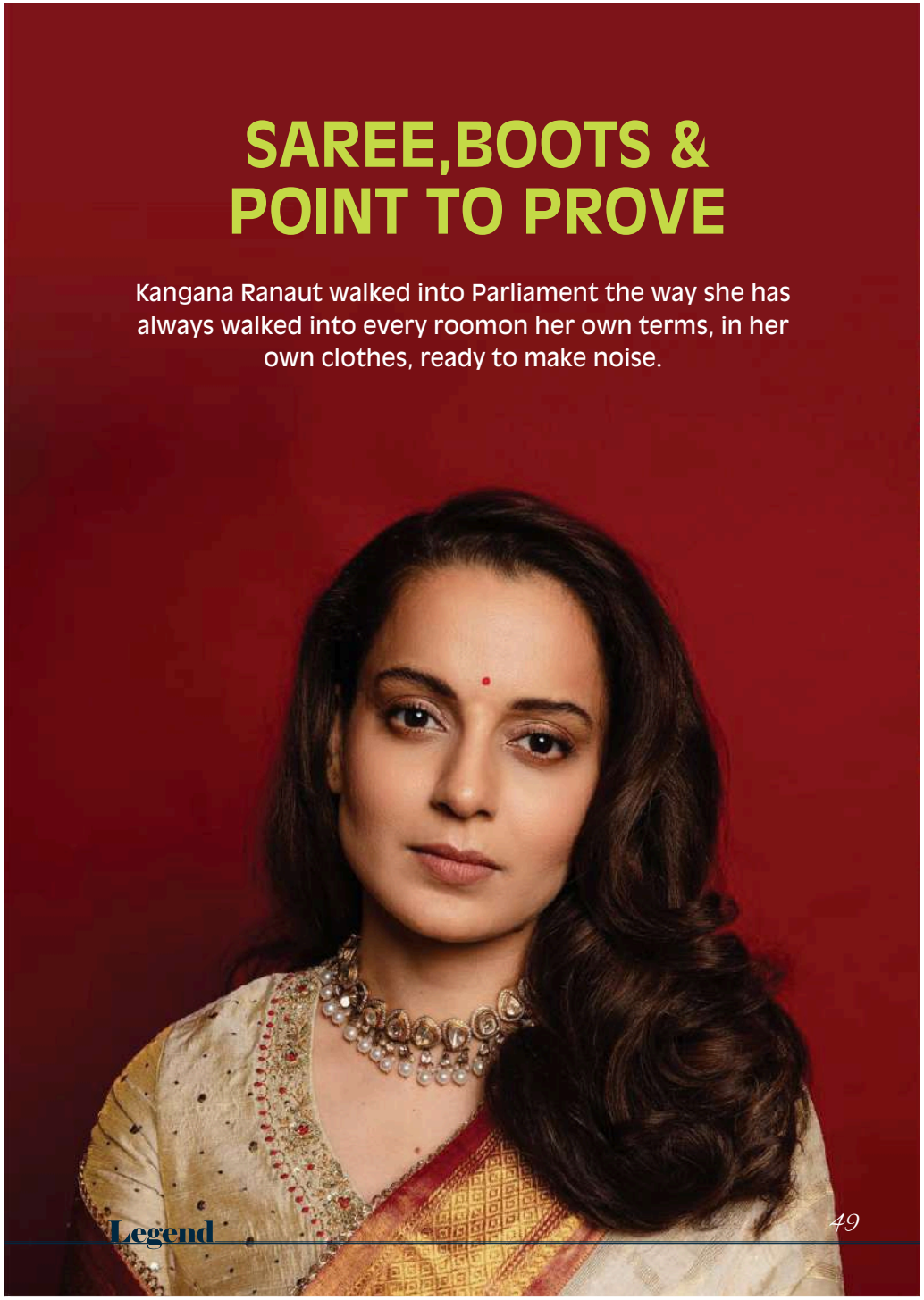


India's Banking Legend Honored

Veteran banker Uday Kotak, founder of Kotak Mahindra Bank, has been conferred the Padma Bhushan in 2026one of India's highest civilian honorsfor his exceptional contribution to the trade and industry sector, particularly in transforming India's banking and financial ecosystem. The award was announced on the eve of the 77th Republic Day (January 26, 2026) as part of the Padma Awards 2026, which included 131 recipients across Padma Vibhushan, Padma Bhushan, and Padma Shri categories. The Padma Bhushan recognizes Uday Kotak's lifetime of institution-building, principled leadership, and enduring contribution to India's financial sector. From starting Kotak with just ₹30 lakh (less than $80,000) borrowed from family in 1985 to building a ₹4.2 lakh crore banking empire with 1,752+ branches, assets worth $68 billion, and 25+ million customers, Uday Kotak's journey represents one of India's greatest entrepreneurial success stories. Upon receiving the Padma Bhushan, Uday Kotak humbly remarked, "We have miles to go before we sleep." Speaking on X (formerly Twitter), he expressed deep gratitude: "I am humbled and honoured to be conferred the Padma Bhushan. The India of today is unrecognisable from the one I was born in. The journey has been exhilarating. On this Republic Day, we stand at the fork of many roads. I choose the path of karma with a sense of paranoia, with aspiration, but conscious of ground realities. I have a deep conviction that we, the people will make India even greater.

SAREE,BOOTS & POINT TO PROVE

Kangana Ranaut walked into Parliament the way she has always walked into every roomon her own terms, in her own clothes, ready to make noise.



Nobody expected Kangana Ranaut to be a quiet parliamentarian. She has never been quiet about anything. What surprised people including, by her own admission, herself was how seriously she took the job. Since her historic win from Mandi in Himachal Pradesh, the actress-turned- legislator has navigated one of the steepest learning curves in public life from film sets and press conferences to constituency grievances, policy debates, and the particular unglamour of broken drains and rural road connectivity. She made that transition without apology and without pretence. "I was told it required sixty to seventy days a year," she said candidly in early 2026. "It is a full-time commitment." Coming from a film industry where image management is a professional discipline, that kind of honesty is its own statement.





The Wardrobe as Manifesto

If Kangana'swords have always been deliberate, her clothes in Parliament have been equally so and considerably more strategic than they first appear. Her signature look a structured Kullu heritage coat layered over a crisp saree, finished with pointed leather boots and an Hermès satchel reads at first glance as a collision of worlds. Traditional and luxury. Local and global. Pahadi wool and Parisian leather.

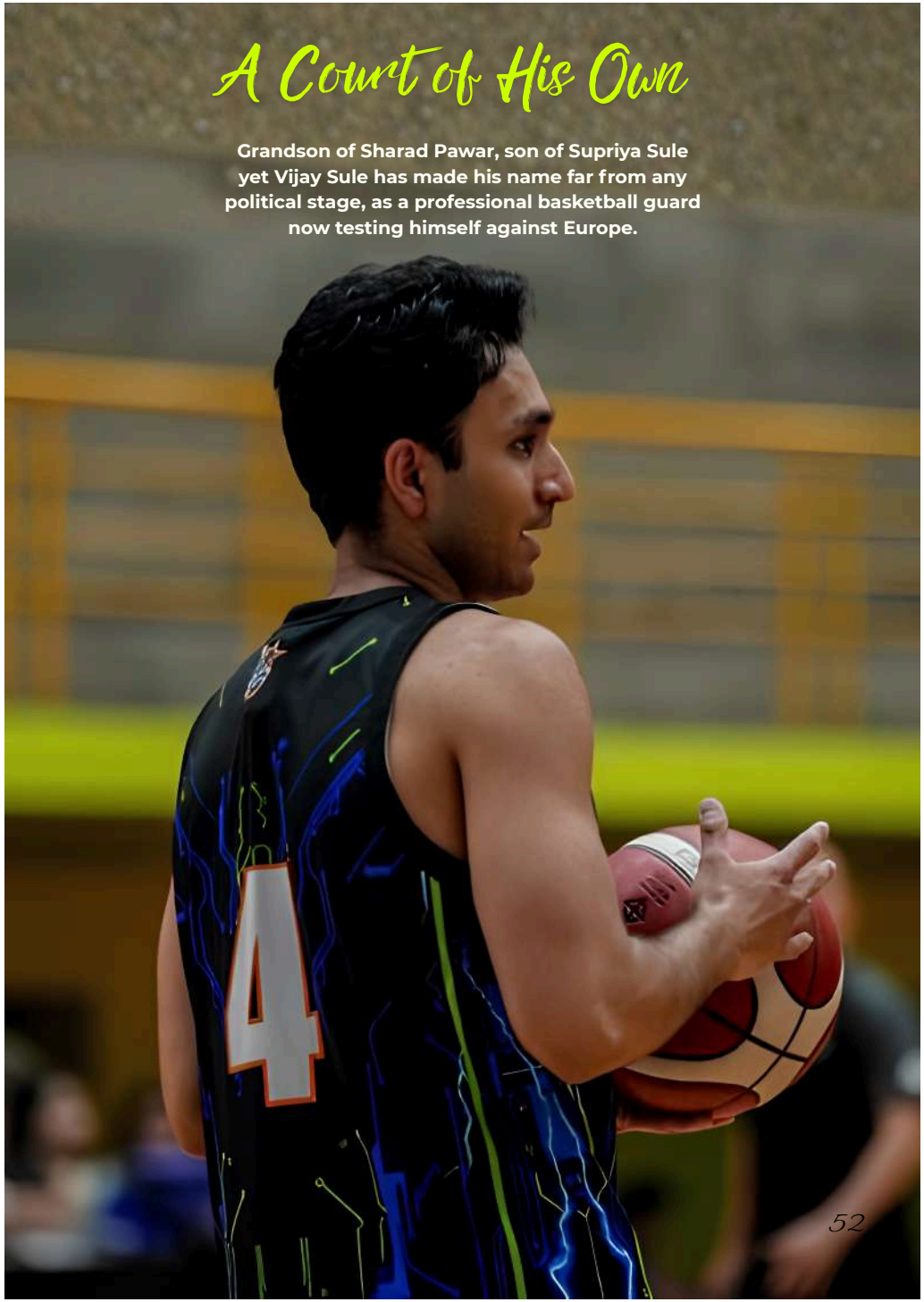
That collision is entirely intentional.

The Kullu coats she wears are woven by women-led artisan associations from her home state indigenous wool, Pahadi craftsmanship, centuries of textile tradition carried into the halls of Parliament on the back of a sitting MP. Every time she walks through those corridors, she is carrying her constituency with her literally. Her saree-sweater pivot replacing traditional blouses with fine-knit turtlenecks and pastels is practical as much as aesthetic. Long parliamentary sessions demand functionality. She found a way to be functional without abandoning elegance, and in doing so created a Parliament style that the fashion industry has watched closely and the handloom sector has quietly celebrated.

is a wardrobe Vocal for local.

Inside the Chamber

ThecelebrityMPstereotype high attendance at launches, low attendance in Parliament does not apply here. Kangana has maintained attendance figures that put many career politicians to shame, peaking at 100 percent in certain sessions. She sits in the front rows. She participates. Her maiden speech focused on the preservation of tribal heritage in Kinnaur and Lahaul- Spiti not the obvious headline-grabbing topic, but the one that mattered most to the people who sent her there. She has raised questions on rural electrification, DISCOM financial stress, disaster relief for Himachal flood victims, and India's Critical Mineral Mission. These are not glamorous issues. They are the issues that determine whether the lives of ordinary Himachalis improve or stagnate. She shows up for them.



A Court of His Own

Grandson of Sharad Pawar, son of Supriya Sule yet Vijay Sule has made his name far from any political stage, as a professional basketball guard now testing himself against Europe.

GROWTH WITHOUT COMPROMISE

When Indian basketball talks about the handful of players willing to leave home and chase the professional game abroad, the list is short and the road is lonely. Vijay Sule is quietly becoming one of those names.

He carries one of Maharashtra's most recognisable surnames. His grandfather, Sharad Pawar, has shaped the state's politics for the better part of half a century; his mother, Supriya Sule, is a sitting Member of Parliament and among the most prominent leaders of her generation. Stepping into that inheritance would have been the easiest thing in the world. Vijay chose a basketball court instead.

A Mumbai-born guard, he spent his formative years learning the game overseas — in the United Kingdom and the United States, including a run with the New York City Black Eagles — before earning a professional contract in Thailand with Team CNX Orion in the Warriors League. It was there, in a quicker and more physical competition, that he began to turn heads: a string of double-digit outings, and one night in particular when he buried five three-pointers against one of the league's strongest sides. For a player without a marquee college pedigree, film is everything. Strong performances abroad, Vijay has said, gave him the game tape he needed to pitch himself to clubs around the world.

The pitch worked. Early in 2026 he signed with US Titans, a Kaunas-based club in the Lithuanian system — the beating heart of a country whose obsession with basketball rivals any in Europe. Joining mid-season, he walked into one of the continent's most demanding development environments, exactly the kind of proving ground he had been chasing.

On the floor, Vijay profiles as a modern two-way guard: a perimeter shooter with the handle to run an offence and the willingness to defend. His game has been shaped by adapting, again and again, to leagues faster and more physical than the last.

The more telling story, though, may be off the court. Vijay has put himself behind grassroots development, working to build pathways that barely existed when he set out — routes for young Indian players to test themselves overseas rather than settling for the domestic ceiling. In interviews and on podcasts he speaks bluntly about the structural gaps in Indian basketball, and why the fortunes of the national team are tied to fixing them.

It is an unusual thing, in a family whose currency is public life, to build your name in the anonymity of a foreign locker room. But that is rather the point. Vijay Sule is not trading on a surname. He is building something entirely, unmistakably his own.





That gave me really good film to send to teams around the world

- VIJAY SULE

on the performances that opened doors in Europe

The move to Kaunas is more layered than a straight transfer. US Titans is a club in transition: after years competing in Armenia's Probasket A-League, it has been folding itself into the Lithuanian basketball pyramid through a partnership with the Lithuanian Basketball Academy. In practice that means a calendar spread across the country's third-tier RKL, the Kaunas city league and a clutch of cup competitions a great deal of basketball, against a great many styles, for a guard still widening his range. For a player whose entire career has been an exercise in adaptation, it is almost tailor-made. Vijay has framed the destination as deliberate rather than opportunistic. Lithuania, he points out, is one of the rare countries where basketball outranks football in the national imagination precisely the environment he had pencilled into a long-term plan to break into Europe.



That instinct to treat a personal breakthrough as a template others might follow runs through everything Vijay does away from the game. His own profile pairs "professional basketball player" with "founder" in the same breath. Off the court he runs **Sniper Basketball Academy**, his own set-up in Pune, alongside a wider development effort that organises exposure trips to the United States, stages showcases, and tries to knit together the two things Indian prospects rarely get in one place: serious coaching, and a route that respects their studies.

The Ecofeminist Rewriting

Climate Leadership

Shreya Ghodawat is proving that sustainability isn't a cause you join it's an identity you build, one startup at a time.



GROWTH WITHOUT COMPROMISE

There's a particular kind of courage it takes to walk away from a title. Not a job a title. CEO. CSO. Founder. The kind of words that took years to earn and even longer to say out loud without flinching. Shreya Ghodawat gave hers up anyway. It happened quietly, somewhere between Sweden and Mumbai, at the end of a year she'd later describe as one where all her highlights had unfolded in the shadows. She had built a fintech startup from scratch, worn every C-suite hat a founder is expected to wear, and then deliberately stopped. She let go of the tech startup, shed the string of titles, and for the first time in years, found space to simply exist without them. It was less a retreat than a recalibration. Shreya was rebuilding, on her own terms, the version of leadership she actually believed in. That instinct to interrogate success rather than simply chase it has defined her entire career.

A Childhood Across Continents, A Cause Rooted in India Born and raised in India, Shreya spent her formative years across Singapore, New Zealand, Switzerland and Sweden, absorbing cultural and indigenous perspectives on sustainability that went well beyond textbook environmentalism. It was during her sociology studies at the National University of Singapore a module on food systems, of all things that something shifted. A deep dive into the realities of dairy farming sent her down a path she never came back from, reshaping how she saw consumption, cruelty, and complicity.

She had, by then, already been building startups since she was seventeen. Entrepreneurship wasn't a career pivot for Shreya it was simply the language she thought in. In 2020, she founded Sustainable Guides, built to educate travellers on ethical eco-tourism a response to years of her own travel across dozens of countries, watching indigenous communities absorb the cost of an industry that rarely asked their permission first. A year later, she co-founded Simppl, a sustainable fintech venture aimed at nudging everyday consumers toward more mindful, eco-conscious spending. Her academic credentials read like a manifesto in themselves a degree in Business Sustainability Management from the University of Cambridge, alongside a master's in Sustainable Tourism but ask anyone who's shared a stage with her, and they'll say the degrees are almost beside the point. What stands out is the conviction. During her university years, she organised a TEDx Countdown event on climate change that drew over 1,200 attendees proof, early on, that she had both the ideas and the ability to make a room listen. What sets Shreya apart in a crowded field of climate advocates is her refusal to treat sustainability as separate from justice. Her work deliberately centres the Global South and communities of colour the people most affected by the climate crisis, and most often left out of the conversation about solving it.







Sustainability isn't a buzzword it's simply a way of life.

- Shreya Ghodawat

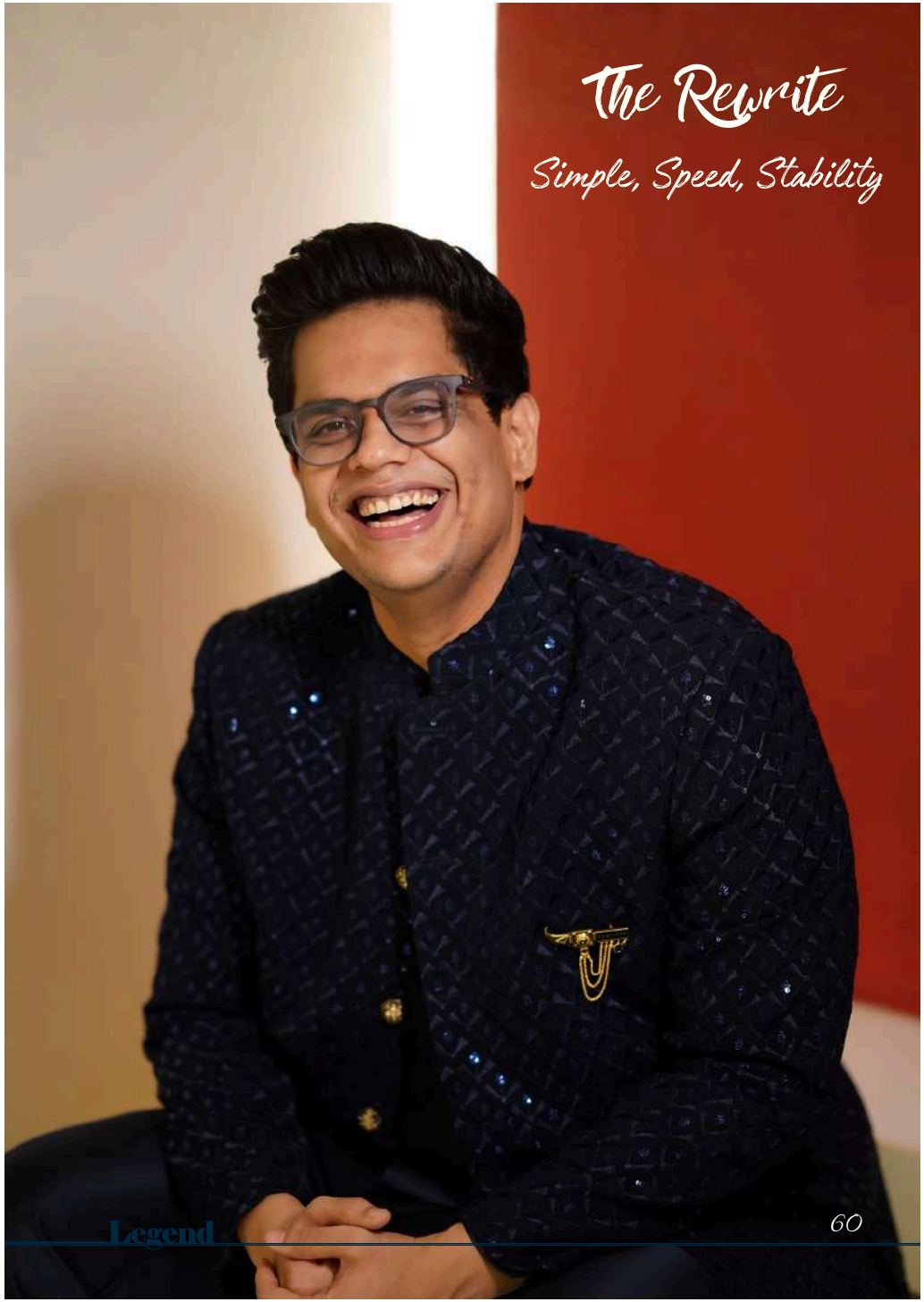
Sustainability Strategist & Ecofeminist

That conviction earned her national recognition. In 2023, she was appointed India Ambassador for She Changes Climate, a global campaign pushing for equitable female leadership in climate decision-making. She hosted the campaign's inaugural Indian event at One8 Commune, Pune part film screening, part rallying cry, entirely aimed at pushing women to claim more space in climate leadership.

Scroll through her LinkedIn and you won't find a curated highlight reel. You'll find a founder who's written openly about running a company while managing anxiety and ADHD about the exhaustion of being the face of a brand when some mornings, showing up at all feels like the achievement.It's this candour rare in founder circles obsessed with projecting invincibility that has made her one of the more trusted voices in India's sustainability ecosystem.



She now also advises Ahimsa VC, India's first vegan venture capital fund, lending her lens to where the country's green capital actually flows.It's advice that sounds simple until you watch someone actually live by it through a fintech exit, a continent change, and a very public conversation about mental health that most founders would rather keep private. In a world that often mistakes ambition for exhaustion, **Shreya Ghodawat** offers a quieter template one where impact doesn't come at the cost of self, and success is measured in balance as much as growth. As she builds her next chapter, one thing remains constant: the belief that a kinder planet begins with kinder leadership.



The Rewrite

Simple, Speed, Stability

"I MOVED TO BANGALORE TO CHANGE MY CIRCLE"



There is a version of the Indian success story that runs in a straight line: school, degree, job, promotion, corner office, obituary. Tanmey Bhat's runs in loops. He does not build a career so much as he builds versions of himself shipping each one, watching it break, and rewriting from the top. He is currently on his fourth. It is the one corporate India has started paying attention to.Version one was a boy in combinaison jokers at the line from 2006. He wrote for television award shows, hosts other people's mouths. It is the least glamorous appetrischop in entertainment and the most useful: you learn that a punchline is a unit of work, that it has a deadline, and that nobody claps for the writer. Version two arrived in 2013 as a YouTube channel with an unprintable name. India's Bakh'd Bhat with Gurshinran Khambra. Rohan Joshi and Ashish Shakya was funnier than the establishment and, more dangerously, better organised. In 2015 the comedy collective had become a creative agency writing branded films for corporate clients. That was the real disruption. ABIP did not simply prove that Indians would watch comedy on the internet; it proved a joke could carry a rate card, an invoice and a payroll. Every creator economy conference held in this country since is a footnote to that discovery. Version two ended abruptly. In 2018, during the McToo rehonoring that sweep, the middle-class was critiquing the for his handling of complaints against a colleague. He stepped down as chief executive. The channel went quiet. The company he had built into an institution stopped, and the man who had spent a decade being loud had nothing to say.

What he did next is the part founders should study. In mid-2019 he opened a channel under his own name and started again at the bottom of the ladder he had built vlogs, reaction videos, streams of Among Us and PUBG, playing games at midnight with an audience half his age. It looked like a retreat. It was a rebuild. He was in effect, doing user research on the next decade of Indian attention, and doing it in public, without the protection of a brand. He rebuilt the body too. At his heaviest he was 168 kg. He moved from Mumbai to Bengaluru by his own account, less for work than to change the room he was standing in and came down to around 113 kg. The method was aggressively unglamous: badminton instead of the gym he hated, one anchor meal a day, shoes placed where his feet would find them in the morning. He calls it conquering the mind before the body. It is also, note, the same operating principle as the rest of his career: reduce friction, then repeat. Version three was the investor. In 2020 he wrote his first cheque, into the investment platform smallcase, and kept going CRED. The Souled Store, Ultrahuman, Wint Wealth, the climate venture Alt Carlon. Upwards of twenty companies now, one exit, one unicorn. He is candid that the appeal is proximity rather than returns: angel investing gives him the thrill of the founder's life without the founder's job. Version four is the one with a staff. In 2023 that co-founded Moonshot with Deviah Bahopanna, his old AIB collaborator, and put the whole apparatus back together for the writer's room, the client list, the appetite for making advertising that behaves liar content instead of interrupting it.





Founders are phenomenal. They are hardened by life.

- Tanmay Bhat

Youtuber & Comedian

The output is the loud stuff you have already seen: Rahul Dravid losing his temper for CRED, Karan Johar and Peyush Bansal arguing about spectacles, Swiggy Instamart's 'Chawal', M.S. Dhoni for Fireboltt. In 2025, at the Good Ads Matter Awards, the agency walked out with the golds and the title of Independent Agency of the Year, ahead of shops with forty-year head starts and international parents.

He remains sceptical of his own mythology. When a wealth report valued him at Rs 665 crore earlier this year, he did not take the compliment he publicly told everyone the figure was wildly wrong. It is a small thing, and a telling one. The man is unusually uninterested in being a legend and unusually good at being useful.





Which is the actual lesson of the loops. Bhat did not monetise fame; that is the ordinary trick, and India now has thousands of people performing it. He industrialised attention turned it into an agency with clients, a portfolio with cap tables, and a discipline that looks suspiciously like manufacturing. Four versions in, the joke has become infrastructure. And he is almost certainly already writing the fifth.

THE ARCHITECT OF INSTITUTION

How a law student at Oxford is reshaping what institutional leadership means for his generation

Viraansh Bhanushali sits in a small cafe near St Peter's College, Oxford, with the kind of ease that comes from belonging everywhere and nowhere at once. At twenty-two, he is in the final year of a jurisprudence degree, but the arc of his life has already traced a pattern unusual for someone his age: the weight of consequential legal work, the burden of institutional reform, and a quiet conviction that systems are not immutable. Last summer, Viraansh interned at the Office of the Solicitor General of India in New Delhi. The role would have been impressive for any law student—access to high-stakes Supreme Court filings, collaboration with senior advocates, exposure to matters of constitutional consequence. But Viraansh did not simply attend. He drafted submissions for one of the most closely watched cases of the decade: the Article 370 Public Interest Litigation, which would reshape the legal framework governing Kashmir's status within India. He was twenty-one. "I wasn't there to observe," he recalls. "I was there to contribute. The Solicitor General's office doesn't bring in students for ceremonial reasons. hey needed drafts, they needed research, they needed someone who could think through the constitutional implications at speed." That kind of stakes—the knowledge that one's work genuinely mattered to real outcomes—has shaped his trajectory.

A few months earlier, interning at the Crown Prosecution Service in London, he had reviewed cases involving multi-million-pound financial crimes, drafted submissions on the Fraud Act, and seen high-value prosecutions reach conclusion. The thread connecting these experiences is not prestige; it is consequence.

But the work that most reveals Viraansh's deeper preoccupation began at Oxford itself, in January 2023, when he co-founded The Oxford Majlis—a society dedicated to rigorous debate on classical Islamic jurisprudence, international law, and contemporary legal challenges. What could have been another student society became something else: a platform that grew to over 700 active members, where weekly debates drew audiences of 100, where policy papers on cryptocurrency taxation and decentralized autonomous organizations found their way into the hands of practitioners and policymakers. To build that from nothing required more than intellectual horsepower. It required drafting a constitution that satisfied Oxford's regulatory requirements. It required establishing Majlis Forum Ltd., securing charitable status with the Khaldun Foundation, and solving the operational problems that would have derailed a less deliberate founder.





"I learned that constitutions exist on paper, but institutions live in practice. The gap between them is where everything actually happens."

- Viraansh Bhansushali
Faculty of Law, University of Oxford

"Viraansh understood that having good ideas wasn't enough," recalls a fellow organizer. "He understood that if you want an institution to last, it has to be built on structures that can outlive you. That's not how most students think."That philosophy—that institutions matter, that their architecture shapes their outcomes, that thoughtful constitutionalism is not an abstraction—led him to the Oxford Union, where he served as Deputy Returning Officer, co-authoring what the Union describes as its largest rules reform in recent memory. Over 200 pages of updated regulations. Hundreds of hours of negotiation, drafting, and political navigation. "He didn't approach it as ceremonial," says someone involved in that process. "He approached it as a constitutional moment. Viraansh graduates in the summer of 2026. What comes next is less important than what has already become clear: he is someone for whom law is not a credential or a toolkit, but a lens through which to see how human institutions can be built to last, and how they might be rebuilt when they fail. In a generation often marked by irony and disengagement, he has chosen the harder path of genuine institutional stewardship.



The question is not whether he will succeed in law. It is what kinds of institutions he will choose to build.

> *"He didn't approach it as ceremonial," says someone involved in that process. "He approached it as a constitutional moment.*

experiences is not prestige; it is consequence. But it is in the gap between consequence and institution that Viraansh's particular talent reveals itself. You can be a brilliant advocate in a single case, a crucial drafter in a single brief. These are temporary victories. What happens when the case closes? When you move on to the next matter? Viraansh wanted to build something that would keep producing consequence after he left institutions that could outlive the moment that created them.



This impulse, rarely visible in ambitious law students, would define how he approached everything that followed. ? These questions sound abstract until you realize they underlie everything from whether a student society still exists five years after you graduate, to whether the Majlis Forum Ltd. will have charitable status that persists, to whether the Oxford Union's reformed constitution actually prevents the kinds of dysfunction that necessitated reform in the first place. "Most people," he says, "treat institutions as containers for their ideas.



One Drop AT A TIME

CrepDog Crew: Building India's Sneaker Culture

What began as a simple hunt for a pair of Yeezys soon turned into one of India's most exciting sneaker success stories. In 2019, Anchit Kapil, along with Bharat Mehrotra and Shaurya Kumar, noticed a clear gap in the market: sneaker lovers in India wanted rare, authentic pairs, but the reseller space was unorganized and unreliable. That insight became the foundation of CrepDog Crew, which first started as an Instagram page and later evolved into a full-fledged marketplace built around trust, culture, and community.CrepDog Crew was never just about selling shoes. From the beginning, it was about creating a destination for people who saw sneakers as more than fashion as identity, as lifestyle, and as self-expression. They have built the brand around a simple but powerful promise: authenticity, variety, and great service.

That formula helped the platform move from selling just a few pairs a week to delivering hundreds of sneakers across hundreds of Indian cities. Today, CrepDog Crew stands as one of India's finest sneaker reselling and streetwear platforms. The company has grown into a multi-crore business with a strong online presence, a wide catalog, and physical experience stores that reflect the energy of global sneaker culture. Its retail model blends commerce with community, giving sneaker enthusiasts a place not just to buy, but to discover, connect, and belong. The brand's rise also reflects a bigger shift in India's youth culture. What was once a niche hobby for a few collectors has become a fast-growing lifestyle movement. CrepDog Crew helped shape that transformation by giving Indian consumers access to limited-edition sneakers, premium streetwear, and a reliable marketplace where trust mattered as much as hype. That balance is one of the reasons the brand continues to stand out in a crowded marke



more than a store

CrepDog Crew's real strength lies in how it turned a niche market into a recognizable culture. It gave India a premium sneaker destination that felt local but looked global. With curated drops, experiential stores, and a strong digital identity, the brand built an ecosystem around streetwear that feels aspirational yet accessible.In many ways, CrepDog Crew is not just a store it is a statement. It speaks to a new India that values individuality, design, and authenticity. And it proves that a business born from passion can grow into a brand that defines an entire lifestyle. For Anchit Kapil and his co-founders, the story of CrepDog Crew is still unfolding, but its place in India's sneaker culture is already unmistakable. CrepDog Crew is more than just a sneaker reselling platform it is one of the most important names in India's evolving streetwear culture. What began in 2019 as a passion project by Anchit Kapil, Bharat Mehrotra, and Shaurya Kumar has grown into a brand that represents authenticity, taste, and a deep understanding of what the modern Indian sneaker community wants. The idea was simple but powerful: create a trusted space where sneaker enthusiasts could access limited-edition pairs, premium streetwear, and a shopping experience that felt premium yet personal. In a market that was often fragmented and unreliable, CDC stood out by bringing structure, credibility, and culture together under one roof.

Authentic Curated. Culture-led.

The strength of CrepDog Crew lies in the way it transformed a niche interest into a movement. Sneakers were never just products for this community they were identity, status, expression, and passion.



CDC understood this better than most and built its brand around that emotion. From its early beginnings as an Instagram page to becoming a full-fledged marketplace and retail destination, the journey reflects the founders' sharp instinct and commitment to creating something meaningful. The brand's growth also mirrors a larger shift in India, where young consumers are increasingly looking for global fashion, limited drops, and brands that speak their language. CDC answered that demand with precision.

INDIAS HOME
FOR SNEAKER DREAMS



The Long Conversation

Beyond the Gram

Raj Shamani built one of India's most-watched business podcasts.

Then he spent four years building the machinery designed to outlive it.



THE ROOM HE BUILT

There is a particular kind of Indian founder the last decade has produced: one who understood, earlier than most, that attention is a raw material like any other minable, refinable, and, crucially, perishable. Raj Shamani has built a career on the third of those.

He is thirty, or close to it, and the shape of what he has built is unusual enough to be worth describing precisely. There is a manufacturing business in Indore. There is a podcast watched by millions. There is a venture studio in Mumbai that builds consumer brands for people whose only asset is an audience. And there is a portfolio of early-stage bets that stretches from fintech to preventive healthcare. None of these is the hobby of the others.

The origin story has been told often enough that Raj has grown wary of it. His father's health failed when Raj was sixteen; the family business went with it. He borrowed a small sum the figure most commonly cited is ten thousand rupees and began selling a dishwashing liquid door to door. The product was called Jadugar Drop. By 2015 it had been folded into the family's chemical trading operation to form Raj Industries, a manufacturer of household cleaning products that he still directs.

It is an unglamorous foundation, and he knows it is his most valuable asset. In a sector crowded with founders whose first exposure to a P&L came after their first viral video, Raj had already run one before he could legally sign the paperwork.

Figuring Out launched in 2021, into a country that had just discovered long-form video and had nowhere Indian to spend it. The format was unfashionably patient: two chairs, no interruptions, an hour or more. The guest list compounded the way guest lists do Nikhil Kamath, Kunal Shah, Deepinder Goyal, Falguni Nayar, Ghazal Alagh until it became the room Indian founders passed through on their way to being understood.

What Shamani did with that room is the interesting part. Most creators of his scale converted attention into the obvious thing: brand deals, appearances, a book. He did those too. But he also appears to have concluded, quite early, that the audience was a wasting asset. House of X, founded in 2022 with the e-commerce operator Neeraj Kumawat, was the answer to that conclusion. The pitch was infrastructure: sourcing, operations, marketing and customer management assembled into a platform that could take a creator from idea to live D2C brand in a matter of days. The capital arrived quickly — Lightspeed, Lumikai, Better Capital, Gruhas, and a long tail of founder-angels from Razorpay, Zerodha, Mamaearth and Meesho. Four years on, the industry has begun asking harder questions of the category, and House of X has not been exempt from them. .



Let me prove that I can do this as well

- Raj Shamani

INDIAN ENTREPRENEUR

The central critique is that reach and purchase intent are not the same instrument: a creator can move a million views and still not move a repeat order. Margins, returns, supply chains and the unromantic arithmetic of consumer goods do not respond to charisma. Whether creator-led brands can survive past the launch spike remains, honestly, unsettled

Rajis not a bad person to be testing the thesis. He is, unusually, a creator who has also run a factory who knows what a delayed consignment does to a quarter. The scepticism directed at his category is scepticism he has arguably been voicing longer than his critics have.





Then there is the capital. Shamani has backed more than twenty Indian and international startups — Wint Wealth, GrowthSchool, Classplus, the Swedish preventive-health company Neko Health among them. It is the least visible of his three businesses and, in the long run, possibly the most consequential. A podcast makes him legible to founders. Cheques make him useful to them. That is the actual architecture, once the noise is stripped out: a manufacturing business that taught him operations, a media business that gave him access, and an investing practice that converts the access into ownership. Each feeds the others.

THE MALKIN

Strand by Strand, She Sold India It's Confidence Back



A PROBLEM SHE WORE ON HER HEAD

Some founders find their market in a spreadsheet. Parul Gulati found hers in a mirror. She was already working Punjabi cinema, Hindi television, the early streaming series that would soon become a genre of their own when she noticed the thing that lighting cannot fix. Her hair was thinning. In an industry where hair occupies half the frame, this was not a cosmetic inconvenience. It was a professional threat, and it arrived with a silence attached: hair loss is one of those Indian subjects that millions of women live with and almost nobody names. The market offered her two bad options, Imported extensions priced like jewellery, or local ones that behaved like a costume. Neither had been made with Indian hair, Indian texture, or Indian weather in mind. So she did the thing actresses are not supposed to do. She said it out loud. Nish Hair began in 2017 in a Mumbai flat, with a founder, her mother Urmiil Gulati, and starting capital of five thousand rupees. There was no team, no warehouse, no funnel. There was Parul sourcing hair, Parul stitching wefts, Parul packing boxes, Parul answering messages from strangers at two in the morning who wanted to know, quietly, whether anyone would be able to tell. The first year returned roughly fory thousand ruppees. Months passed with three sales in them. Most founders would call that a failed experiment; she called it a signal, because of what those three customers wrote back afterwards. They did not write about the product. They wrote about how they felt walking into a room. That was the insight the imported brands had missed entirely.

Nish Hair was never in the hair business. It was in the confidence business, and hair was simply the medium. Somewhere along the way, Parul stopped marketing Nish Hair and started performing it. She christened herself Nish Hair ki Malkin the Owner and turned the internet's favorite pastime into her distribution channel. When people made memes about her, she made better ones. When commentators suggested her looks had done the selling, she made content about it rather than a statement against it. It is a rare kind of nerve: a founder who is also the face, the joke, the customer-service voice and the credibility all at once. But the strategy was never really about visibility. It was about permission. Every reel in which she clipped in an extension on camera, unbothered, told a few thousand women that the thing they had been hiding was, in fact, ordinary. By the time she walked into the finale of Shark Tank India's second season, the brand had substance behind the storytelling. She asked for one crore ruppees for two per cent a valuation of fifty crore, and an audacious ask by the room's standards. Vineeta Singh and Aman Gupta counted at three per cent. Amit Jain did not counter at all; he offered exactly what she had asked for, and the negotiation that followed became one of the season's most replayed exchanges. She left with the cheque, and with something more useful than capital: national permission for the category itself.Orders roughly five hundred per cent in the three months that followed. Revenue crossed ten crore in FY23 and kept climbing.







"I'm proud to be one of the first to openly talk about hair loss."

- Parul Gulati

Founder NISH HAIR

Ask what Nish Hair sells and the honest answer is a Tuesday morning. Not a red carpet, not a wedding, not a photoshoot an ordinary day in which a woman does not have to think about her parting.

That is a harder product to build than it sounds. It requires human hair, hand-selected and hand-stitched, sourced through channels she has insisted on keeping clean. It requires price points that do not treat dignity as a luxury good.

It requires a founder willing to keep her own face on the category long after she could comfortably hire someone else's.

Parul still acts. She has said she works twenty-two-hour days to hold both lives open, which sounds like a boast until you meet the specific stubbornness behind it: she does not intend to be an actress with a business, or a businesswoman who used to act. She intends to be both, and to have neither be a hedge against the other.





The ambition now points outward: international markets, salon and offline partnerships, a men's line for a demographic that has been suffering the same silence with even fewer words for it. Headline about vulnerability. Parul Gulati made it a business plan, then made the business plan the headline, and somewhere in between made it unremarkable for a woman to say the sentence at all. Empires have been built on less. Very few have been built on something so small, so ordinary, and so quietly heavy as the thing a woman sees when she looks in the mirror at seven in the morning.

EKUAL

CONFIDENCE. COMPETENCE. CULTURE

Ekual is a modern finishing school and professional development company that equips students, professionals, and corporate teams with the human skills required to thrivemaking world-class education accessible to everyone, regardless of background

EKUAL OPPORTUNITY

How Ekual is Bridging the Gap Between Knowledge and Readiness

Success is no longer determined solely by academic qualifications or technical expertise. In today's world, the ability to communicate effectively, build meaningful relationships, navigate professional environments, present oneself with confidence, and adapt to changing circumstances has become equally important. Yet these essential life and professional skills are rarely taught in traditional education. Ekual was founded to bridge that gap. At Ekual, we believe that a person can have all the right credentials yet lack the presence to command them. A graduate can be brilliant in theory and still falter in practice. Universities teach what you know. They say nothing about who you become. The world demands both.

We are a modern finishing school and professional development company dedicated to equipping students, young professionals, and corporate teams with the human skills required to thrive in today's interconnected world. Our mission is simple: to make the knowledge, confidence, and social intelligence traditionally reserved for a privileged few accessible to everyone. The future belongs to individuals who can combine competence with character, expertise with empathy, and intelligence with influence.

Employers increasingly seek graduates who can communicate with confidence. Universities look for students who can lead and collaborate effectively. Organisations need professionals who can represent their brands with credibility and professionalism.

These skills are not innate. They can be taught, practiced, and mastered.

Ekual exists to provide that education.

WHAT WE DO

Ekual designs and delivers transformative learning experiences focused on nine core areas:

Professional Presence & Executive Confidence
how to command a room and carry authority.

Communication & Interpersonal Skills
how to listen, connect, and build genuine professional relationships.

Public Speaking & Presentation Skills moving beyond information delivery to persuasion and influence.

Workplace Readiness & Career Preparation navigating office dynamics and professional growth.

Leadership & Decision-Making strategic thinking and team leadership.

Personal Branding & Digital Presence how you're perceived, online and offline.

Emotional Intelligence & Relationship Building self-awareness and the social intelligence that underlies all advancement.

Business, Social & Dining Etiquette the practical codes of formal professional and social settings.

Personal Development & Life Skills resilience, adaptability, and the foundations of continuous growth.

Our programs are carefully tailored for schools, universities, educational institutions, corporate organizations, and individual learners. Rather than relying on generic lectures, we combine practical application, real-world scenarios, interactive workshops, behavioral psychology, and modern workplace insights to ensure meaningful and measurable outcomes.



We believe that talent is everywhere, but opportunity has been unequally distributed. Ekual exists to change that. When people are given the right tools, knowledge, and guidance, they don't just improve their skills they transform the way they show up in the world.

- Kshriraja Surendranath

Founder CEO of Ekual

THE STORY BEHIND THE NAME

Ekual is inspired by the idea of equality. We believe that every individual, regardless of background, deserves access to the skills that create opportunities, elevate careers, and unlock personal growth. Success should not be determined by who your parents know or which school you attended. It should be determined by what you're willing to learn and how committed you are to becoming your best self.

OUR VISION

To become India's leading modern finishing school and life-skills education platform, empowering individuals from all backgrounds with the confidence, competence, and social intelligence required to succeed in life, work, and leadership

OUR COMMITMENT

Every Ekual program is built on a single belief:

When people are given the right tools, knowledge, and guidance, they do not simply improve their skills. They transform the way they show up in the world.

We are not merely teaching etiquette or soft skills.

We are helping build confident students, capable professionals, thoughtful leaders, and empowered individuals ready to succeed in a rapidly changing world.



I started Ekual because I saw brilliant people held back not by lack of talent, but by lack of presence. A student could be exceptional in every way—intelligent, capable, ambitious—and yet struggle to command a boardroom or build authentic professional relationships. The issue wasn't their potential. It was their preparation. The world expects you to have presence, confidence, and social intelligence from day one, yet nowhere teaches you how That's the inequality I wanted to solve. Ekual isn't about teaching etiquette or surface-level soft skills. It's about building the foundational human skills that allow talent to actually be seen and heard. When we empower someone with confidence and presence, we're not just changing their career trajectory—we're changing how they see themselves. That's the real transformation.".

The Second Founder

Simple, Speed, Stability



THE APPRENTICESHIP IN THE AISLES

What he has been doing since is something harder building new companies inside an old one.

As Vice Chairman of the RP-Sanjiv Goenka Group, he sits at the centre of one of India's most diversified conglomerates power and green energy, chemicals, retail, FMCG, IT-enabled services, media, education and sport. But the more revealing detail is not the size of what he oversees. It is the number of things inside it that did not exist before he arrived. He came back from the Wharton School at the University of Pennsylvania into the least glamorous corner of the group: retail. Spencer's Retail was a legacy brand with a long history and a difficult present, operating in the hardest sector in Indian business one where margins are thin, competition is unforgiving, and consumer loyalty is rented rather than owned. It was, in hindsight, the ideal classroom. Retail teaches operating discipline the way no boardroom can. Shashwat spent those years on store networks, cost structures and shelf-level economics, learning the business from the floor upward. In May 2023, in a deliberate act of succession planning, his father stepped down as Chairman of Spencer's Retail and Shashwat took the chair. What he did with it says something about temperament. He acquired Nature's Basket from the Godrej Group and repositioned it not as a supermarket but as a destination the Artisan Pantry format, a luxury grocery concept built around experience rather than assortment. He launched Jiffy, a quick-commerce app, to meet the customer who no longer walks to a store at all.

Guiltfree Industries, which he founded, launched Too Yumm! into a packaged-snacks market dominated by global giants and defended by decades of distribution. The positioning was contrarian at the time: better-for-you snacking, aimed at a consumer who had not yet fully arrived. The category has since become one of the fastest-moving segments of Indian FMCG. The bet was early, which is another way of saying it was a bet. That instinct — to build rather than only to steward — now runs through the group's newer businesses. Personal care through Naturali and Within Beauty. Ayurveda through Dr. Vaidya's. A move into global specialty chemicals through the Aquapharm acquisition. In each case, the pattern is the same: identify. where the Indian consumer or the Indian industrial base is heading, and get there before the incumbents notice. If retail was the apprenticeship and FMCG the proof, energy is the ambition.

The group's roots are in conventional power CESC has lit Kolkata for generations. Shashwat now spearheads the renewable business: solar, wind, green hydrogen and ammonia, built out through Purvah Green Power. In August 2026, Purvah agreed to acquire a 1.4 GWp operating solar portfolio from ReNew Solar Power at an enterprise value of ₹4,859 crore among the largest operating-solar transactions India has seen. It takes contracted capacity to 4.8 GWp against a stated platform target of 10 GW.The structural point is more interesting than the number.







It's about the ability to adapt, evolve and lead change

- Shashvat Goenka
INDIAN BUSINESS EXECUTIVE

The acquisition shifts Purvah from a platform built mostly on projects under development to one anchored by assets already generating contracted cash flows. It is a patient move dressed as an aggressive one the difference between announcing a pipeline and owning a business. In 2024, the World Economic Forum named him a Young Global Leader.

He chairs the CII National Committee on Retail and the FICCI Young Leaders Forum, and sits on boards across the group CESC, Firstsource Solutions, PCBL and RPSG Ventures among them. In July 2025, RPSG Sports completed the acquisition that created Manchester Super Giants, a joint venture in English cricket in which he serves as Vice Chair an Indian conglomerate exporting sporting capital to England, rather than the other way around.



THE LONG VIEW

The Goenka name carries more than two centuries of commercial history behind it from his grandfather R.P. Goenka's construction of one of independent India's great industrial houses, to his father Sanjiv Goenka's decision in 2011 to build a new group from a division of it. Twice in three generations, the family has chosen to start again rather than sit still.

Shashwat Goenka is not the exception to that pattern. He is its continuation. He inherited a conglomerate; what he appears to be building is his own.

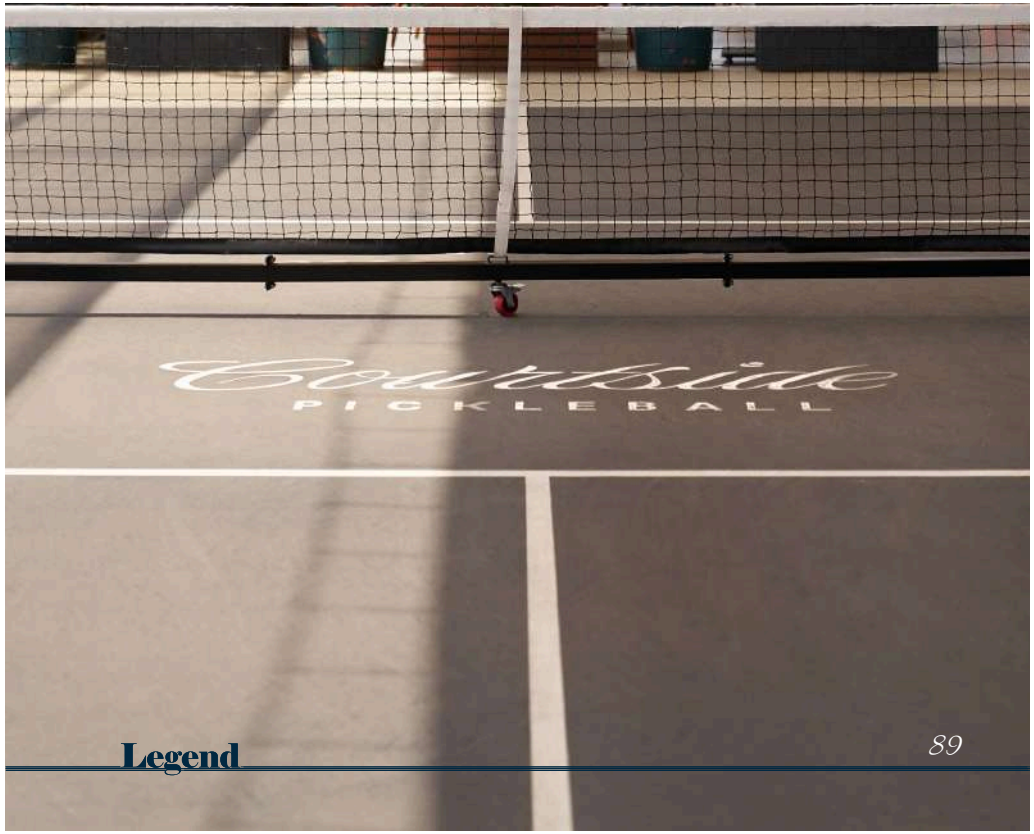
COURTSIDE: PLAY. STAY. REPEAT.



THE MODERN THIRD SPACE

In a city that rarely slows down, Courtside brings Mumbai something refreshingly different a reason to stay. Founded by childhood friends Hardik Vardhan, Shyam Utamsingh, and Shoumik Shetty, the 20,000 sq. ft. luxury social club in Worli is more than a sports venue. It is a modern third space built for movement, connection, and everyday ritual. Around the rise of padel, the founders have created a destination where people can play, eat, recover, work out, and socialize without ever feeling rushed. Courtside feels like a natural response to the way urban life is changing. People today are no longer looking only for places to be seen they are looking for places that give them a reason to return.

That is exactly what Courtside delivers. With three state-of-the-art padel courts, a pickleball court, an all-day bistro and cocktail bar, specialty coffee and matcha, Pilates and Barre, and dedicated wellness recovery spaces, the club blends sport and hospitality into one seamless experience. It is active, stylish, and deeply social without feeling overdesigned or exclusive. What makes Courtside stand out is that it was never imagined as just a padel club. It was built around a larger idea: that the best social spaces today are the ones that feel alive throughout the day. A morning coffee can become a game. A workout can lead into lunch. A match can turn into an evening drink. That fluidity is what gives Courtside its energy.



A PLACE TO PLAY, STAY, AND RETURN.

What makes Courtside truly special is its understanding of the modern urban rhythm. It is built around the idea that the best spaces are no longer those reserved for rare occasions, but those that become part of everyday life. At Courtside, a morning coffee can turn into a game, a workout can flow into lunch, and a post-match drink can stretch into an evening of conversation overlooking the courts. That fluidity gives the club its soul. It is less a sports facility and more a social ecosystem one that reflects how people today want to spend their time: actively, meaningfully, and in community. In a city that is always moving, Courtside offers something rare and valuable a reason to stay



Style Meets Sport

Courtside is not just introducing a new venue to Mumbai it is introducing a new mindset. In a city that has long measured luxury through exclusivity, Courtside shifts the focus toward experience, rhythm, and belonging. The founders, Hardik Vardhan, Shyam Utamsingh, and Shoumik Shetty, have imagined a space that does not ask people to choose between sport and social life, wellness and indulgence, or movement and pause. Instead, it brings all of it together in one elegant flow, creating a place that feels alive from the first coffee of the morning to the last conversation of the night. That is what gives Courtside its character: it feels modern without being cold, premium without being intimidating, and social without ever feeling forced.

What makes the idea even more compelling is that Courtside understands how people actually want to live today. Not in fragments, but in transitions. A workout can become a meeting point, a game can become a ritual, and a casual visit can turn into a habit. The club captures that in a way that feels effortless. There is a quiet intelligence in how the space is built not to impress for a moment, but to stay relevant every day. With padel courts, pickleball, wellness sessions, recovery experiences, food, coffee, and cultural energy woven into one destination, Courtside becomes more than a club. It becomes a feeling of momentum, a place where Mumbai's fast pace meets a slower, more intentional kind of living.



THE NOOK: A BEAUTIFUL PAUSE IN THE HEART OF BANDRA

The Nook is not simply a new chapter; it is an evolution of everything she loves most. It brings together her instinct for hosting, her eye for atmosphere, and her desire to build something meaningful in people's everyday lives. More than a café, The Nook is a reflection of her worldview one that believes the best spaces are the ones that let people slow down, feel held, and leave a little lighter than they arrived. In the end, The Nook is not just about coffee, food, or design. It is about emotion. It is about creating a place where the ordinary becomes memorable, where quiet moments gain meaning, and where people feel at home even when they are away from it. Through The Nook, Rashi Morbia has built something rare and beautiful: not just a destination, but a feeling people will want to return to, again and again.



Home But Better!









The Nook: Where Bandra Comes to Feel at Home

Building Spaces That Make People Feel at Home

In a city that is always moving, where time is short and moments often pass too quickly, The Nook arrives as a gentle interruption a space designed not just to be visited, but to be felt. Created by Rashi Morbia, The Nook is more than a café; it is an expression of her love for connection, her instinct for hosting, and her deep understanding of how spaces can shape emotion. What began as an event space has now evolved into something even more intimate and enduring a place where people can pause, gather, work, rest, and simply exist. For Rashi, The Nook was never about building just another hospitality concept.

It was born from something far more personal: her obsession with spaces that make people feel something real. After running her first event space, she realized that what stayed with her was not the grandeur of occasions, but the intimacy of the in-between moments the conversations over coffee, the laughter that lingered after the party ended, the ease with which people connected when the setting felt honest and warm. When that chapter came to a close, she knew she wanted to create something more grounded, more personal, and more alive in everyday life. That idea became The Nook. What makes The Nook special is that it has evolved beyond being a place it has become a state of mind. Rashi imagined it as a third space, one that blurs the lines between home and outside, work and rest, day and night.







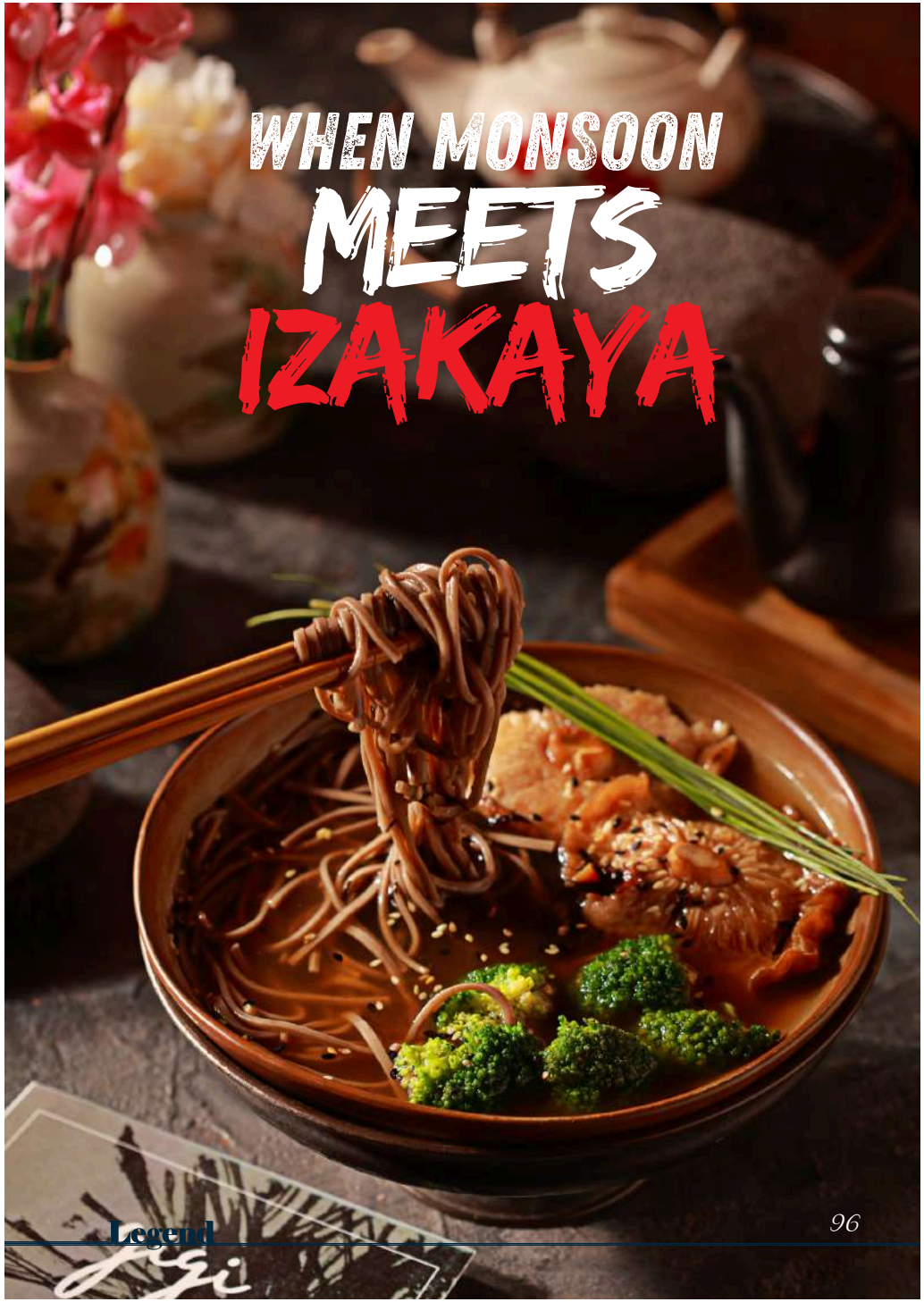
That emotional clarity is reflected in every detail. The Nook is warm, tactile, and layered the kind of space that invites people in gently and lets them settle at their own pace. Whether someone walks in alone with a book, catches up with friends over coffee, or stops by between meetings, the experience is meant to feel deeply personal. Rashi's vision was simple yet powerful: to create a place that feels like your corner of the world. A place that offers belonging without performance, comfort without excess, and beauty without intimidation.

At the heart of this vision is Rashi herself thoughtful, intuitive, and deeply attuned to the emotional life of spaces. Her journey with The Nook reflects a modern entrepreneurial spirit rooted not in scale, but in sensitivity. She understands that true hospitality is not just about serving people; it is about seeing them.

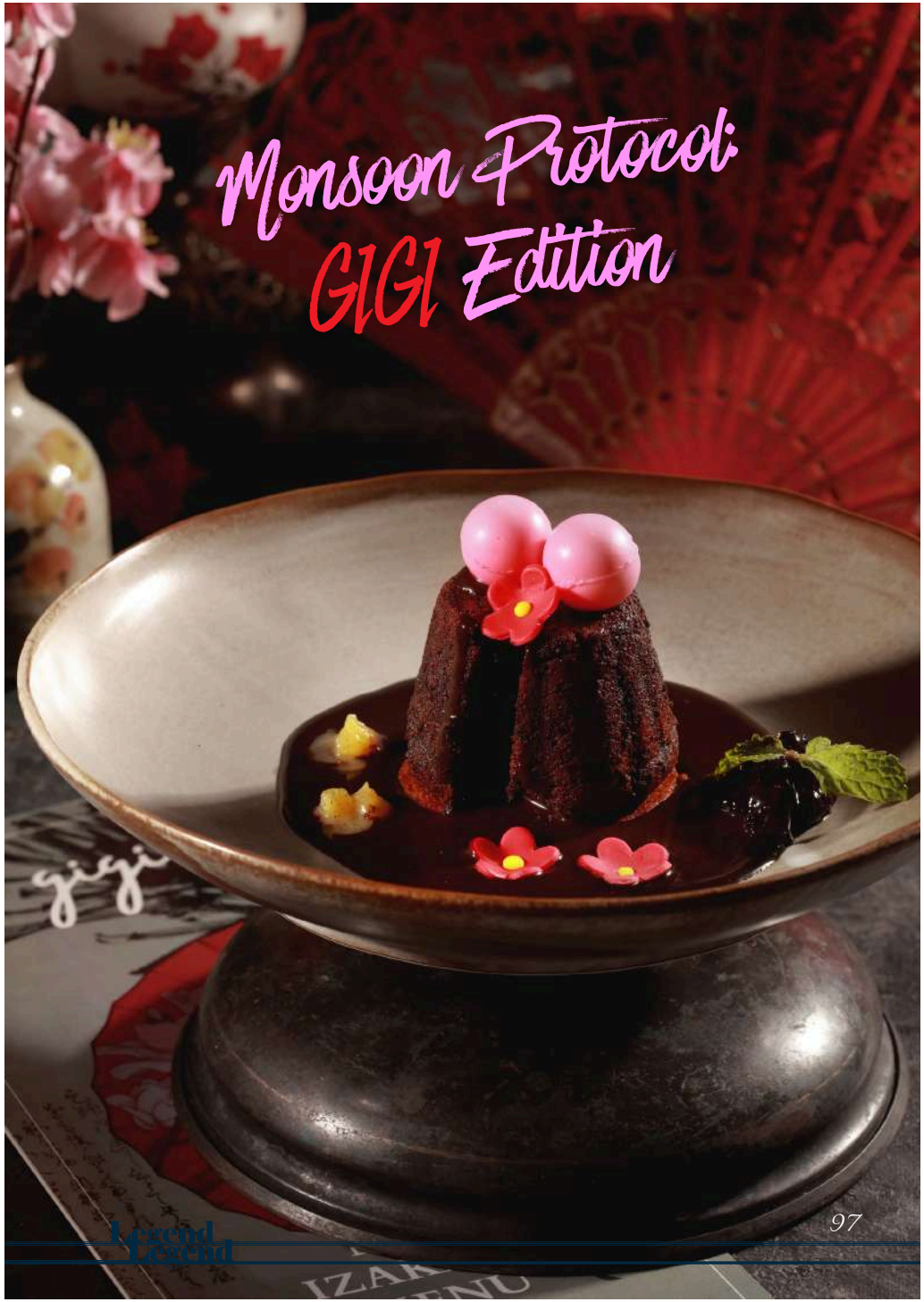
That understanding is what gives The Nook its identity. It feels less like a commercial venture and more like an invitation one shaped by a founder who values the softer things that often matter most: atmosphere, ease, connection, and memory.

The menu, too, has been created with that same sense of intention. For Rashi, food and drinks had to feel alive. They had to tell a story, not through unnecessary complexity, but through thoughtfulness. The result is a menu that brings together timeless classics and playful experimentation from affogatos and spritz-style cold brews to drinks that feel almost like desserts. Every offering reflects The Nook's personality: refined yet warm, creative yet approachable, stylish without losing its soul. It is a menu designed not just to impress, but to connect with every mood and moment.

WHEN MONSOON MEETS IZAKAYA



Monsoon Protocol: GIGI Edition



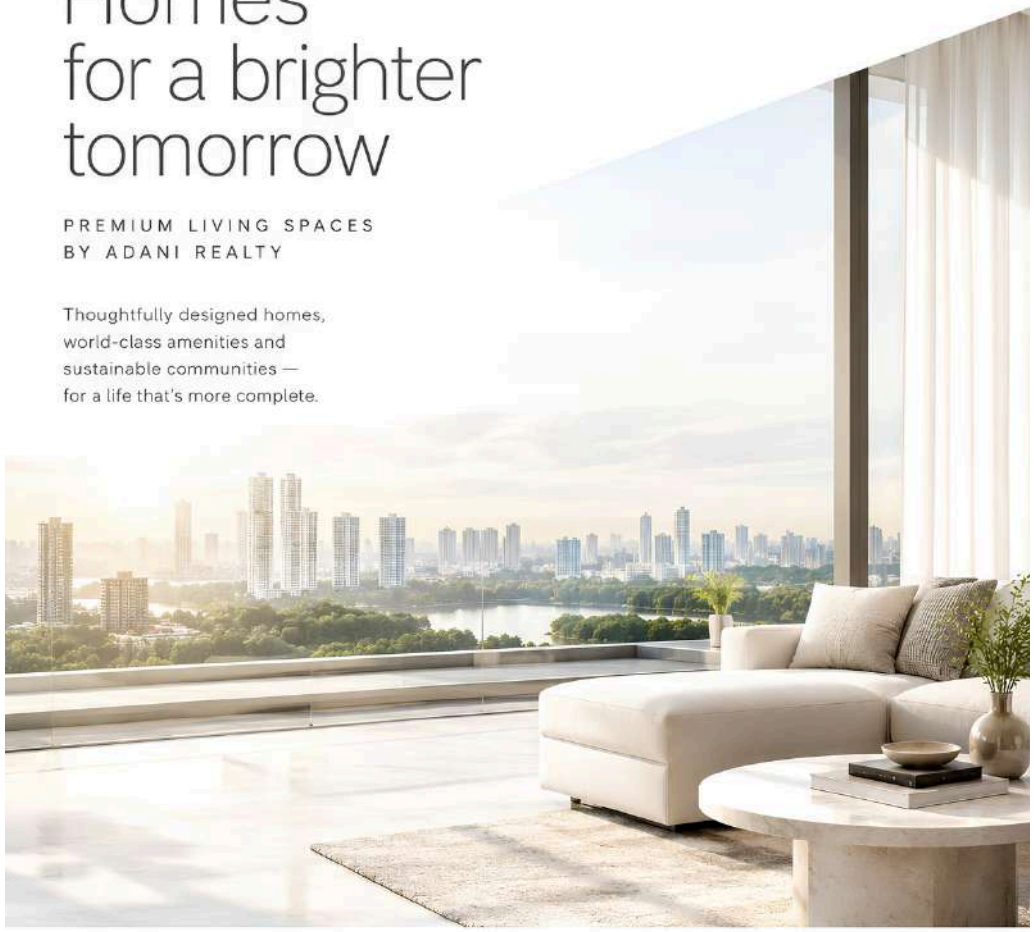
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